

MODSIM

A modular simulator for ore dressing plant flowsheets

USER MANUAL

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1 WHAT IS MODSIM?

MODSIM is a simulator that will calculate the detailed mass balance for any ore dressing plant. The mass balance will include total flowrates of water and solids, the particle size distribution of the solid phase, the distribution of particle composition and the average assay of the solid phase. The assay can include mineralogical composition, metal content and element content. Other special particle properties that are specific to particular systems can also be accounted for. Some are calorific value, volatile matter, pyritic sulfur, organic sulfur and ash content for coal, and magnetic susceptibility and electrical conductivity for mineral systems that are processed by magnetic or electrostatic separators. Other, sometimes very subtle, particle properties such as particle shape, mineralogical texture and surface characteristics have important influences on the behavior of some of the unit operations of mineral processing. MODSIM can accommodate all of these particulate properties. The main unit operations of ore dressing include the size-reduction operations, crushing and grinding, classification operations for separation of particles on the basis of size, concentration operations that separate particles according to their mineralogical composition and solid-liquid separations. MODSIM provides a repertoire of standard models for these operations.

MODSIM has a completely modular structure which allows models for the unit operations to be added into the simulator. Thus the models that are used to simulate the operation of the various unit operations can be developed and modified to suit the plant under any operating conditions and can be tuned to meet the needs of any application. This characteristic of MODSIM also allows the user to develop and incorporate the results of ongoing research in the mathematical modeling of the unit operations of mineral processing. The repertoire of models available to the system increases continuously as more are added by users. The user can call on any available model.

MODSIM calculates the composition and completely characterizes the particulate material in each stream of the plant. The output includes the total flowrates of water and solid, the particle-size distribution and the distribution of particle composition over the particle population as well as the detailed assay of each stream. In addition a comprehensive report is produced for the performance of each unit in the plant. The report will vary according to the duty that the unit must handle in its position in the flowsheet. The data in the report can be used for detailed unit design and sizing, for unit costing, for equipment selection and for equipment and process evaluation.

MODSIM is unique among currently available simulators in that it can simulate the liberation of minerals during comminution operations. This aspect of mineral processing plant operation is becoming increasingly relevant as plant managers seek greater operating and plant efficiency.

MODSIM is a steady-state simulator and is not designed to simulate dynamic operations. It is not suitable for the design and simulation of process control systems.

2 HOW TO USE MODSIM

MODSIM has been designed for convenience and speed of use. No elaborate set-up procedures are required and even complex ore dressing plants can be successfully simulated in no more than a few hours. The operation of the system allows the user to concentrate on the metallurgical application and the user is not distracted by essentially



Form 1 The main window from which the operation of the simulator is controlled.

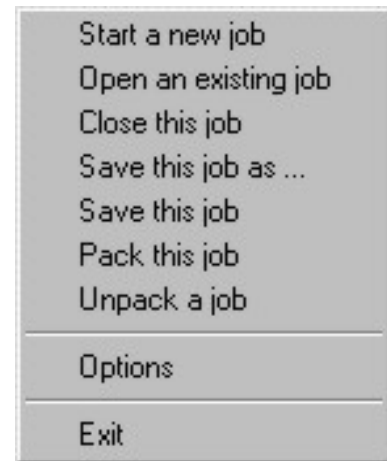
computational problems. Input of information is through graphic construction of the flowsheet by an easy-to-use graphic editor at the user's workstation. Numerical input is through menus and data input forms that allow quick and easy specification of data to define the properties of the ore and the operating parameters for the equipment in the plant. Output is through clearly annotated and formatted printed output supplemented by appropriate graphical representations. Output report files can be browsed from within MODSIM. Copy and paste editing is used to facilitate transfer of output data to spreadsheets and graph plotting programs of the user's choice.

The operation of the simulator is driven from the main menu which is shown in Form 1.

The data and simulations are organized on the basis of individual job names. Each distinct simulation should be given a unique job name. Data and information for each job is stored under the job name so that these can be conveniently stored and recovered.

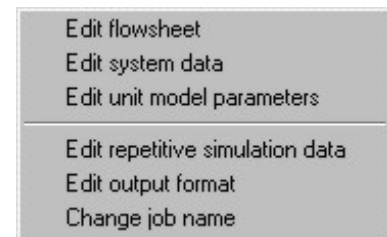
Job names can be up to 8 characters following the DOS file naming convention. Job names must not have file extensions and MODSIM allocates various file extensions to its internal files for each job.

From the FILE menu you can start a new job, open an existing job that was previously saved, and save the current job.



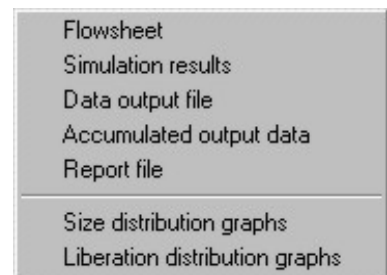
Menu 1 File menu

From the EDIT menu you can edit the flowsheet using the graphic editor, edit the system data, edit the models and the operating parameters, edit the output file format or change the name of the current job. The set up of repetitive simulation data can also be edited. (Professional version only). The data and simulations are organized on the basis of individual job names.



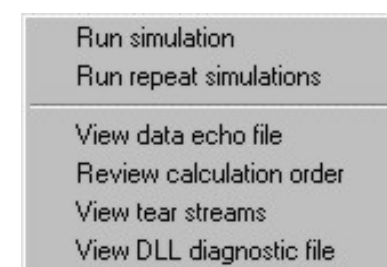
Menu 2 Edit menu

From the VIEW menu you can view the flowsheet, view the data output file, view the report file, view the particle size distribution and/or liberation distribution plots for any stream in the flowsheet and view the liberation spectra in any stream.



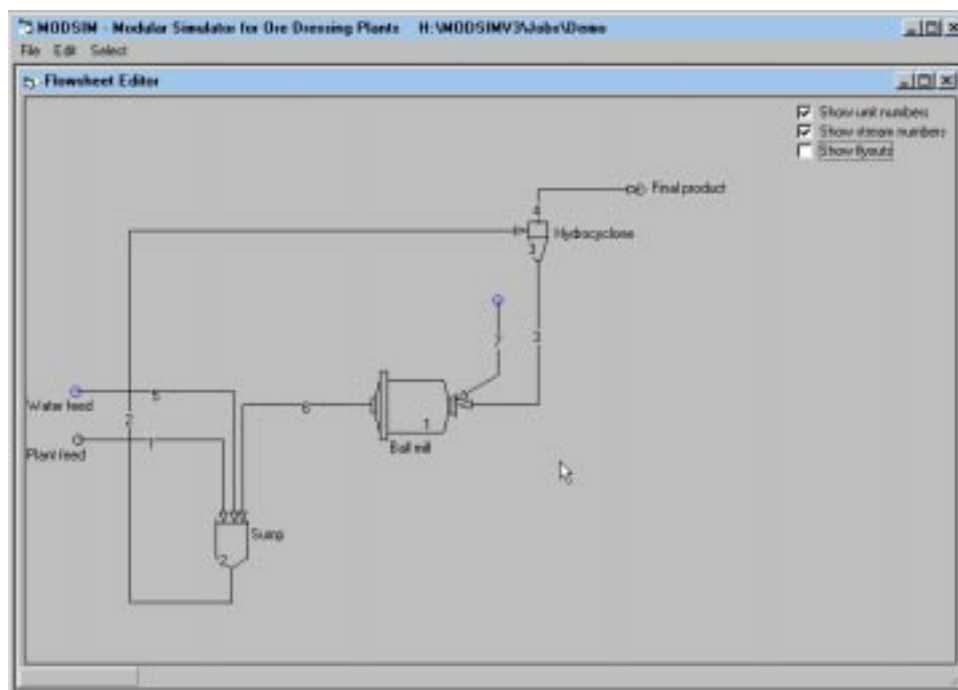
Menu 3 View menu

From the RUN menu you can run the simulation and view four different files that can help diagnose any problems. Repetitive simulations can also be run to help find optimal combinations of unit parameter settings. (Professional version only)



Menu 4 Run menu

3 THE GRAPHICS EDITOR



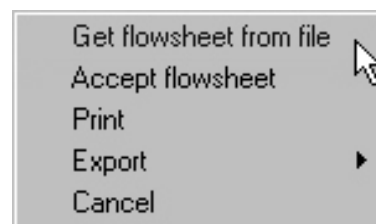
Form 2 A typical plant flowsheet as it appears on the screen during flowsheet construction or editing using the graphics editor.

The essential description of a mineral processing plant is the plant flowsheet. This identifies each of the unit operations in the plant and defines the flow interconnections between them. Process engineers recognize and use the flowsheet to communicate plant structure. MODSIM exploits this practice and allows the user to construct the flowsheet directly on the computer screen or workstation. The flowsheet is drawn using the built-in graphic editor.

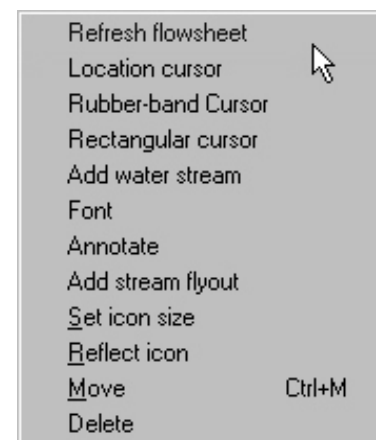
The graphics editor is called from the EDIT menu on the main form.

From the FILE menu of the flowsheet editor you can get a pre-saved flowsheet from file including flowsheets saved from MODSIM Version 2 under DOS (Version 2 flowsheet files have the file extension .tr), accept the currently displayed flowsheet, print the flowsheet, export the graphic image as a Windows metafile or PostScript file or cancel the current editing session.

The editing tools that are used to draw the flowsheet are available from the EDIT menu on the graphics editor.



Menu 5 File menu of the flowsheet editor



Menu 6 The edit menu of the flowsheet editor.

3.1 Drawing Icons on the Flowsheet

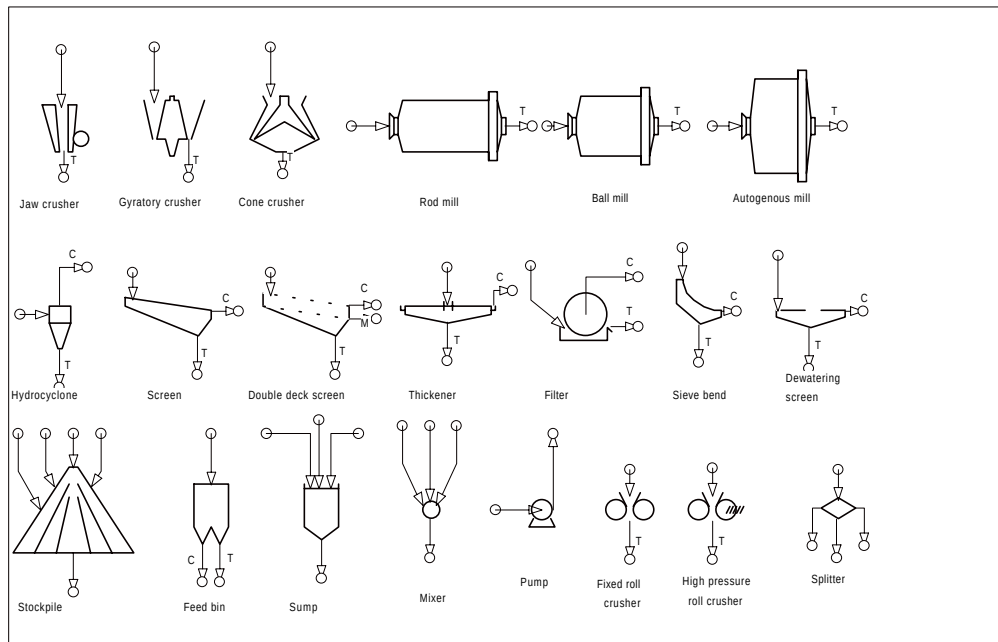


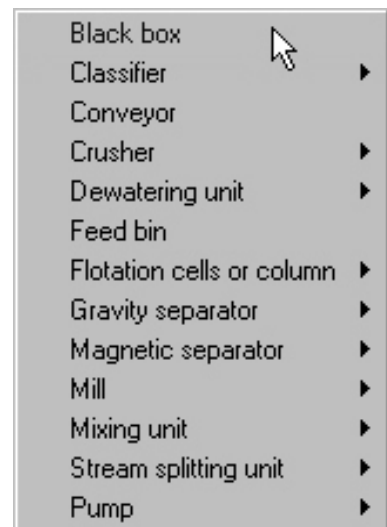
Figure 1 The unit icons. Concentrate streams are identified by C, tailings streams by T and middling streams by M.

The flowsheet is constructed by placing unit icons at the desired positions on the flowsheet and connecting the units by means of the appropriate flow streams. Icons are selected from the SELECT menu and they appear on the flowsheet at the current location of the LOCATION CURSOR. When the location cursor is showing on the flowsheet, it can be dragged and dropped using the mouse. To make the location cursor visible on the flowsheet, select LOCATION CURSOR from the EDIT drop-down menu on the graphics editor.

The available icons are shown in Figures 1 and 2 and in Table 2 at the end of this section. Each type of unit operation has its associated pictorial icon and the appropriate icon is chosen automatically when the unit operation is selected from the SELECT drop-down menu.

3.2 Drawing Streams on the Flowsheet

Units are connected on the flowsheet by streams. A stream is started by positioning the cursor at the appropriate point on the flowsheet and is ended at the appropriate unit. Two different cursors are available to draw process streams. The RECTANGULAR CURSOR



Menu 7 The SELECT menu of the flowsheet editor from which unit icons are selected.

is used to draw streams that consist entirely of horizontal and/or vertical segments. If the stream to be drawn has diagonal segments, use the RUBBER BAND CURSOR. Once the appropriate cursor has been chosen, left click the mouse at the starting point of the stream, left click the mouse wherever a corner is required in the stream and end the stream by clicking the right button. Streams normally start and end at a unit icon. This means that the starting and ending points of the stream must touch the appropriate unit at the point on the icon where the connection is to be made. HINT: A stream that does not attach to a unit icon has a colored circle attached to its end. This makes it easy to detect unattached streams. Plant feed and plant product streams will of course not be attached to unit icons at their starting and ending points respectively. The position on the unit icon of a stream that leaves the unit is significant since its position defines the nature of the product stream - concentrate, tailing or middling product. The location of the stream types is identified in Figures 1 and 2. Unit feed streams can be attached to any point on a unit icon but the streams should be logically placed to ensure that the flow structure of the flowsheet is clear.

Plant feed streams do not start at a unit and plant products do not end at a unit. All units with the exception of a mixer, sump or stockpile can have only a single feed stream. Thus

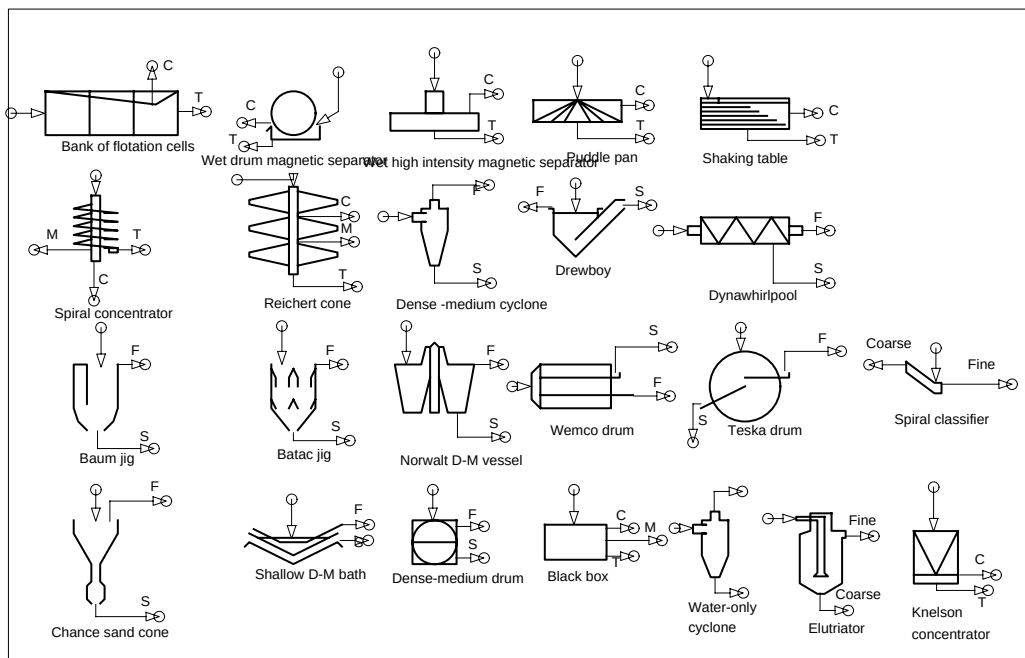


Figure 2 The unit icons. Concentrate streams are identified by C, tailing streams by T and middling streams by M. Dense medium and gravity units have float and sink streams which are identified by F and S in the figure.

all units that are fed from more than one point in the plant must be preceded by a mixer, conveyor or a sump. There is one exception to this rule. A unit can have an additional

water feed stream in addition to the slurry feed. This is useful whenever water is added directly to the unit feed or when water is added to the unit to achieve some physical effect such as rinsing on a screen or adding water to the froth launder of a bank of flotation cells. Water can enter the plant through a water feed stream which is started by selecting ADD WATER STREAM from the EDIT drop-down menu and then completing the construction of stream in the same way as for other plant stream after selecting either the RECTANGULAR CURSOR or the RUBBER BAND CURSOR..

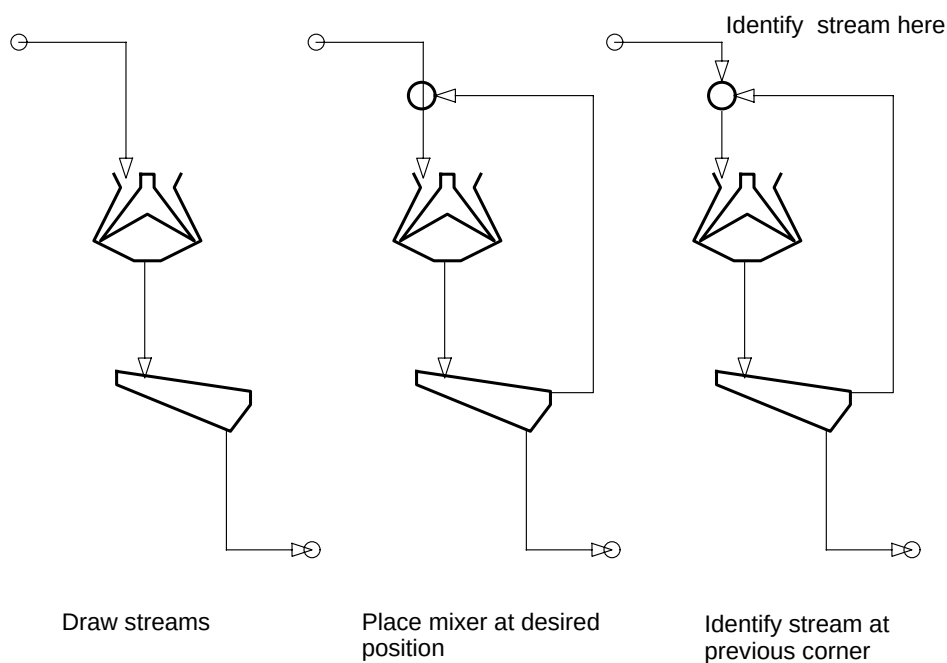


Figure 3 *Sequence of operations showing the insertion of a mixer into an existing stream. The mixer is placed then the stream that is being broken into is identified.*

HINT: A stream that does not attach to a unit icon has a colored circle attached to its end. This makes it easy to detect unattached streams. The audio alarm also sounds when a stream is drawn that does not attach to any unit.

Mixing units may be inserted into streams that have already been placed on the flowsheet. However, after locating the mixer at the desired point, the stream that is broken into must be identified. This is done by locating an identifiable point (stream start or corner) in the stream immediately preceding the mixer and then immediately right clicking the mouse on this point. If any other action is selected before identification of the stream, the mixer will not be inserted into the stream. This sequence of operations is shown in Figure 3.

Streams that feed units are usually attached to a unit that already exists on the flowsheet. To attach a unit to the end of an already existing stream, move the unit until it touches the

arrowhead of the desired feed stream. The stream will be attached when the flowsheet is next refreshed or saved.

3.2.1 Changing Icon Size or Orientation

The size and orientation of unit icons can be varied during the construction of the flowsheet. The size is changed by selecting CHANGE ICON SIZE from the EDIT drop-down menu and specifying the new size in the range 1-20 using the pointer gauge in the top right hand corner of the flowsheet. The new size remains in effect until changed.

Icons that do not have a vertical axis of symmetry can be reflected about their vertical axis by selecting REFLECT ICON. From the drop-down menu. The reflection will apply only to the next unit selected after which orientation returns to normal.

3.3 Deleting Icons or Streams from a Flowsheet

Streams and icons can be deleted from the flowsheet by selecting DELETE from the drop-down menu and right clicking on the stream or icon. When an icon is deleted. All output streams that are attached to that icon are automatically deleted as well. Icons may be moved on the flowsheet by selecting MOVE from the EDIT drop-down menu and dragging the icon with the mouse. When an icon is moved all of its associated output streams will be deleted before the move and these will have to be replaced. Any system data associated with those streams will be lost!!

3.4 ANNOTATING THE FLOWSHEET

Annotations may be added to the flowsheet by positioning the LOCATION CURSOR at the point where the annotation is to start and selecting ANNOTATE from the drop-down EDIT menu. An annotation can be deleted by selecting DELETE from the EDIT drop-down menu and right clicking on the annotation. An existing annotation can be moved by selecting MOVE from the EDIT drop-down menu and dragging the annotation with the mouse.

A typical flowsheet is shown in Figure 4. Annotations may be added freely to the flowsheet to improve its information content. The models that are associated with each icon are given in Table 2.

Table 2 Unit models available in MODSIM

UNIT	Models available
Autogenous mill	FAGM, SAGM, MILL
Ball mill	MILL GMIL GMI1 GMSU UMIL HFMI HFML HFSU
Batac jig	BATJ
Baum jig	BAUJ
Black box	BLBX
Chance sand cone	CHAN
Cone crusher	CRSH CRS1 SHHD
Conveyor	CONV MIXR
Dense-medium bath	TESK BATJ SLIP CHAN BAUJ WEMC NORW WASH DREW
Dense-medium cyclone	DMCY DMHC
Dewatering screen	DWSC
Drewboy dense-medium vessel	WASH DREW
Double deck screen	DSC1 DSC2
Dynawhirpool	DYNA
Elutriator	ELUT
Feed bin	SEGB
Filter	FILT
Fixed-roll mill	CRSH
Bank of flotation cells	FLTK FLTN KLIM
Gyratory crusher	GYRA
Hydrocyclone	CYCL CYCA
High pressure roll crusher	CRSH
Jaw crusher	JAW1 JAW2
Knelson concentrator	KNEL
Magnetic separator	WDMS
Mixer	MIXR
Norwalt dense-medium separator	NORWA
Puddle pan	PAN1
Pump	NOP
Reichert cone	CONE
Rod mill	MILL
Shaking table	SHAK
Screen	SCRN SCR1 SCR2 CYCA
Shallow dense-medium bath	SLIP
Sieve bend	SCR1 CYCB
Spiral separator	SPIR, KELL, LISP
Spiral classifier	CYCA
Stockpile	MIXR
Stream splitter	SPLT SPL1
Sump	MIXR
Teska drum	TESK
Thickener	THIC, KYNC
Water-only cyclone	WOCY
Wemco drum	WEMC
Wet high-intensity magnetic separator	WHIM, DOFI

3.5 Saving Flowsheets

A typical flowsheet is shown in Form 2 on page 5 as it appears on the screen. Annotations may be added freely to the flowsheet to improve its information content and all graphic elements and annotations may be moved or erased to ensure effective and appropriate layout of the flowsheet. A flowsheet is saved by selecting SAVE FLOWSHEET on the FILE drop-down menu. The flowsheet should always be saved before proceeding to data specification.

3.6 Attaching Unit Models to Icons

Each icon in the flowsheet represents a physical unit in the plant. In order to simulate the operation of the plant, the behavior of each unit must be modeled. You will need to associate an appropriate model with each unit and the models that are available for use with each icon are listed in Table 2. Details of the models are given in section 7. The final choice of models is made by selecting EDIT MODEL PARAMETERS from the EDIT drop-down menu on Form 1. The details of model selection and parameter specification are given in section 6

3.7 Pseudo Streams

Sometimes it is useful to have information about the particle load inside a particular unit. For example, it is useful to know the size distribution of the load in an autogenous or ball mill. This information can be gathered in two ways: through the report file(see section 8.4), the unused product streams can be used to report the information during the simulation. The pseudo stream will have zero flowrate but will carry all the composition data. It is drawn on the flowsheet as a product stream that emanates directly from the unit but does not connect to any other unit. This stream will be included in the simulator output and will generate data that can be used to plot the size distributions and the liberation spectra. See section 10.5 for details on how to include pseudo streams in the unit models.

3.8 Saving the flowsheet

The editor is easy to learn and easy to use and even complex flowsheets may be drawn in short sessions. It is recommended that a flowsheet be saved several times during creation to ensure against loss of information caused by any system malfunction.

The flowsheet can be redrawn at any time during the edit session by selecting REFRESH FLOWSHEET from the EDIT drop-down menu and the flowsheet will be redrawn.

The units and stream are numbered automatically by the editor and these numbers are used in the output stage for identification. The structure of the flowsheet is automatically transmitted to subsequent stages in the simulator for interpretation and processing which

includes cycle finding and decomposition algorithms to establish a feasible sequential calculation path for the flowsheet. These algorithms are completely transparent to the user so the step from flowsheet construction to final output is convenient and fast. However, the user must supply the essential numerical data that describes the material to be processed and the set up of the individual units in the flowsheet. These data specification steps are described in sections 4, 5 and 6.

3.9 Printing the Flowsheet

The quickest way to print a hard copy of the flowsheet is to select PRINT from the FILE drop-down menu in the graphics editor. High-quality hard copy can be produced offline using a PostScript image of the flowsheet by selecting EXPORT from the FILE drop-down

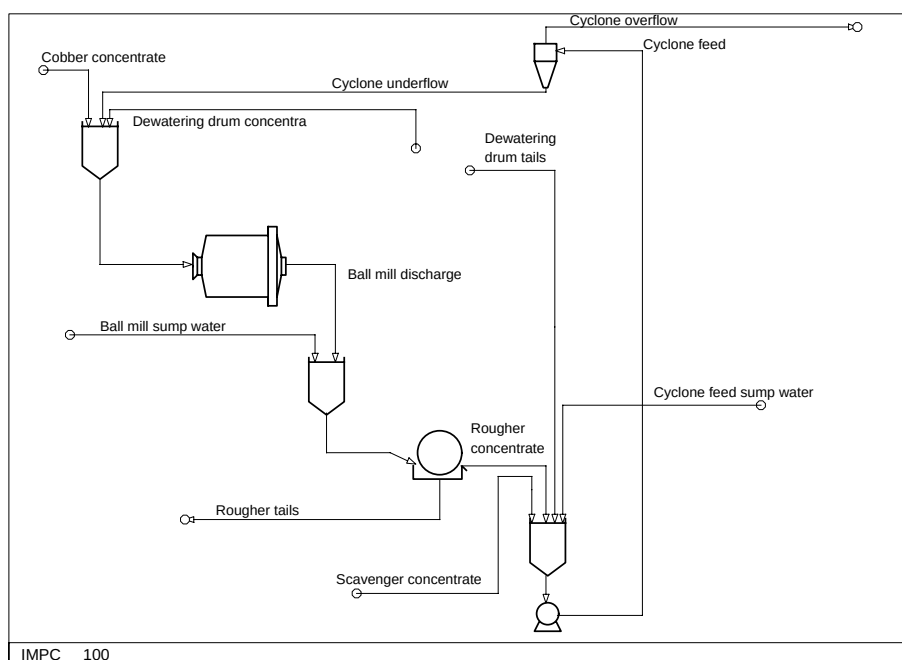


Figure 4 Graphical output of a typical flowsheet using the PostScript image.

menu on the graphic editor. The PostScript image can be sent to any device or application that is capable of rendering PostScript images. However this file cannot be sent to an external device from within MODSIM. If you want to import the PostScript image directly into a word processor export the flowsheet as an encapsulated PostScript image or as a Windows metafile.

4 DATA ENTRY

Once the flowsheet has been constructed, MODSIM will take you through a sequence of menus that will define the data set required by the flowsheet and the included models. The data is separated into two sections. The first defines the system and plant data which includes all information required to define the plant structure and the characteristics of the feed material. The second section includes all the parameters required by each of the unit models included in the flowsheet. These are the unit parameters. Each section may be accessed separately from the main menu.

Some familiarity with the terminology of particulate mineral systems is necessary to specify the data correctly and the user is referred to the book *Simulating Mineral Processing Plants* for assistance in this regard.

4.1 Specifying the System Data

The system data describes the characteristics of the ore that is processed in the flowsheet. These characteristics remain fixed throughout the flowsheet and hence the name system data. System data is also used to characterize the plant feed streams. The system data form is used to set up the system data and to identify streams that feed ore to the plant or

The screenshot shows a dialog box titled "MODSIM - Specify ore characteristics and stream data for job DemoLib". It is divided into two main sections: "ORE CHARACTERISTICS" on the left and stream selection lists on the right.

ORE CHARACTERISTICS:

- Select type of mineral to be processed:** Two radio buttons are present: "Conventional minerals" (selected) and "Coal processing plant".
- Number of minerals:** A text box containing the value "2".
- Mineral names:** Two text boxes containing "Chert" and "Magnetite".
- Specify sp.gr by:** Two radio buttons: "Mineral" and "Particle type" (selected).
- Number of size classes:** A text box containing "25".
- Largest particle size:** A text box containing "5.00E-3".
- Number of grade classes:** A text box containing "12".
- Number of S-classes:** A text box containing "1".
- Buttons:** "Set up grade classes", "Set up S-classes", and "Set convergence properties".

Stream Selection Lists:

- Feed streams:** A list box containing "1 Plant feed".
- Water addition streams:** A list box containing "5 Sump water".
- Internal and product streams:** A list box containing "2 Hydrocyclone feed", "3 Hydrocyclone underflow", "6 Ball mill discharge", and "4 Cyclone overflow".

Bottom Buttons: "Cancel" and "Accept".

Form 3 Form to specify the properties of the ore and to select streams that have data to be specified. This form is entered by selecting the **System data** item on the EDIT menu.

that have experimental data which is to be compared to the simulator output. The format of the form to specify system data is shown as Form 3.

The data fields in this form are described in the sections that follow. The frame labeled ORE CHARACTERISTICS on this form is reserved for the specification of properties that characterize the nature of the solid material that is processed in the plant.

The nomenclature of coal washing technology has evolved separately to that of conventional mineral processing and the user can choose either nomenclature to specify the data. Although the nomenclature varies, the principles that govern the specification of data in these two situations is the same and the simulator works the same way for both type of plant.

ORE CHARACTERISTICS: This composite field is used to specify the physical properties of the ore that is to be processed in the plant.

Number of minerals: Specify the number of mineral species that are significant in the simulation.

Mineral names: The names of the minerals must be specified in this field. There must be as many names as are specified in the **Number of minerals** field. Only the first four letters of the mineral name are significant.

Mineral specific gravities: The specific gravities of the individual minerals can be inserted here.

The specific gravity of individual particle types can be specified in one of two ways: either they are calculated from the mineral composition of the particle type and the specific gravity of the individual minerals or the specific gravities of the particle types can be specified explicitly. One of the two methods is chosen on this form. If the latter method is chosen the specific gravities of the particle types must be specified on Form 4.

Number of size classes: Specify the number of size classes that you want MODSIM to use for the simulation. 25 is recommended since this will provide the greatest resolution with respect to size. The number specified here **need not** be equal to the number of sizes that are available as data that defines the plant feeds nor to the number of size classes that are available in experimental data that is available for comparison with the simulator output. If particle size effects will not be significant in the simulation, the number of particle size classes can be set to 1 and MODSIM will consider that all particles have the same size equal to that specified in the largest particle size field.

Largest particle size: Specify the largest particle size that is of interest in the simulation. This should be just larger than the largest size in the feed. Note that the size must be specified in meters.

Number of grade classes: Specify the number of grade classes that are required to define the liberation characteristics of the ore. If mineral liberation will not be significant. This field should be set equal to the number of minerals. The number of grade classes should never be less than the number of minerals otherwise the simulator cannot distinguish between the separate mineral species.

Number of S-classes: In MODSIM S-classes allow the particle population to be distributed over an additional physical variable such as the magnetic susceptibility for example. Distribution over several values of the flotation rate constant is probably the best known example of the use of S-classes in ore dressing plant simulations.

4.2 Setting up the Grade Classes

The composition of the grade classes can be specified using Form 4 which is entered by clicking the **Set up grade classes** control on the systems data form.

Composition: This form requires the composition of each grade class to be specified. The composition for each grade class is specified in terms of either the mass fraction or the volume fraction of each mineral in the particle. The entry for each grade class is a vector of mineral compositions. The ordering of the minerals in the vector corresponds to the order in which the mineral names are entered in the system data form (Form 3).

Specific gravity of class: By default MODSIM calculates the specific gravity of particles in each grade class from the mineral fractions in the particles and the specific gravities of the minerals that are specified on the system data form. If data on the actual particle specific gravities are available these may be entered on this form. These data will be used instead of the calculated default values. See section 10.1 *Accessing system data in model subroutines* for information on how to access this data from any model subroutines that you write.

Magnetic susceptibility of class: The magnetic susceptibility for each class of particle can be specified here.

Other property: Values for any other physical property can be specified here.

Specify distribution of particle types
Specify the mineral content of each grade class. Separate values with a space

Class	Composition	Sp. gr. of class
1	1.0000 0.0000	2.700
2	0.9500 0.0500	2.767
3	0.8500 0.1500	2.910
4	0.7500 0.2500	3.069
5	0.6500 0.3500	3.246
6	0.5500 0.4500	3.445
7	0.4500 0.5500	3.671
8	0.3500 0.6500	3.927
9	0.2500 0.7500	4.223
10	0.1500 0.8500	4.566
11	0.0500 0.9500	4.970
12	0.0000 1.0000	5.200

Data set
☒ New
☐ Current
☐ Default

Specify composition by
☒ Mass
☐ Volume

Physical properties
☐ Mag. susceptibility
☐ Other

Specify liberation model data

Cancel Accept

Form 4 Form to specify the composition and other properties of the particle types or grade classes. This form is entered by clicking the **Set up grade classes** control on the system data form. See Form 3.

Specify liberation model data: Click this control to specify details of the liberation model.

Specify parameters for models of the Andrews-Mika diagram

"Ljubljana" model
PhiA [10 - 100] 50

☐ Calculate Andrews-Mika diagram for "Ljubljana" model on exit

Beta function model

Liberation size microns 300

Preferential breakage factor 1

Andrews-Mika boundary exponent 1

Andrews-Mika boundary sensitivity .5

Variance exponent 1

Variance sensitivity 1

Asymmetry factor 1

Data set
☒ New
☐ Current data
☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 5 Form to specify parameters of the Andrews-Mika diagram.

This will bring up the Form 5 which is formatted for both the "Ljubljana" liberation model and the beta function models of the Andrews-Mika diagram.

PHIA parameter: This is a parameter that defines the phase interfacial area per unit volume in the mineral. It characterizes the mineral texture for use in the "Ljubljana" liberation model. This parameter takes values in the range of 10 to 200. Minerals

that have lower values of Φ_A have comparatively coarse-grained textures and are comparatively easy to liberate while textures that have Φ_A larger than 100 are finely intergrown and difficult to liberate.

Calculate Andrews-Mika diagram on exit: Check this box if you want the matrix of cross transfer coefficients for the liberation model to be computed according to the “Ljubljana” model. This will be necessary whenever the value of Φ_A is changed.

Parameters for the Beta Function Andrews-Mika diagram: The beta function model of the Andrews-Mika diagram requires 7 parameters. **Liberation size** defines the scale of the mineralogical texture. The mineral phase starts to liberate significantly when the particle size becomes smaller than the liberation size.

Preferential breakage factor defines the relative tendencies for cracks to branch in the mineral phase. If cracks branch preferentially in the mineral phase this factor is greater than 1. If cracks branch preferentially in the gangue phase this factor is less than 1. **Andrews-Mika boundary exponent** is the exponent of the Andrews-Mika boundary. For coarse-grained textures this exponent approaches 3 and is less than 3 for finer grained textures. **Andrews-Mika boundary sensitivity** is the sensitivity of the boundary exponent to parent size. **Variance exponent** The variance of the liberation distribution determines how quickly the minerals separate by liberation as the progeny size decreases. If the variance parameter is high the minerals separate quickly at comparatively small size reduction ratios and *vice versa*. The **variance sensitivity** determines the sensitivity of the variance exponent to the parent size. The **asymmetry factor** defines the relative rate of liberation of the mineral phase relative to the gangue phase. If the asymmetry factor is greater than 1 the mineral phase liberates relatively quickly; if this factor is less than 1, the mineral liberates more slowly than the gangue phase.

Data set: This form allows you to display the default data set, the current data set in the simulator and the new data set that is under construction and to switch among these data sets.

Specify composition by: If the number of grade classes exceeds the number of minerals, the composition of the particles in each grade class must be specified. This specification can be made either by mass or by volume.

4.3 Setting up the S-classes

The values associated with each s-class can be specified on Form 6 which is entered by clicking the **Set up S-classes** control on the system data form (Form 4).

Flotation rate constants: Specify the values of the flotation rate constants that characterize the ore. A common model for flotation cells is the so-called ultimate recovery model which considers each type of grade class to have a floatable and

a non-floatable component. The value of the specific flotation rate constants are specified on this form. The rate constant for the non floatable component is set equal to zero. Two models for mineral flotation are provided as standard in MODSIM: the distributed models due to King and Sutherland. The King model allows for bubble loading limitations and the specific rate constant is specified in m/s. The Sutherland model is based on the analogy with a chemical reaction and the rate constants are specified in mins^{-1} .

Magnetic susceptibility: Specify the values of the magnetic susceptibility for each of the

Class	Flotation rate constant
1	0.500000
2	0.050000
3	0.001000

Data set:
☒ New
☐ Current
☐ Default

Distributed property:
☒ Flotation rate constant
☐ Magnetic susceptibility
☐ Other

Cancel Accept

Form 6 Form to specify the values of properties that are attached to S-classes. This form is entered by clicking the **Set up S-classes** control on the system data form.

s-classes here if you plan to use these values in any of the models for the plant unit operations..

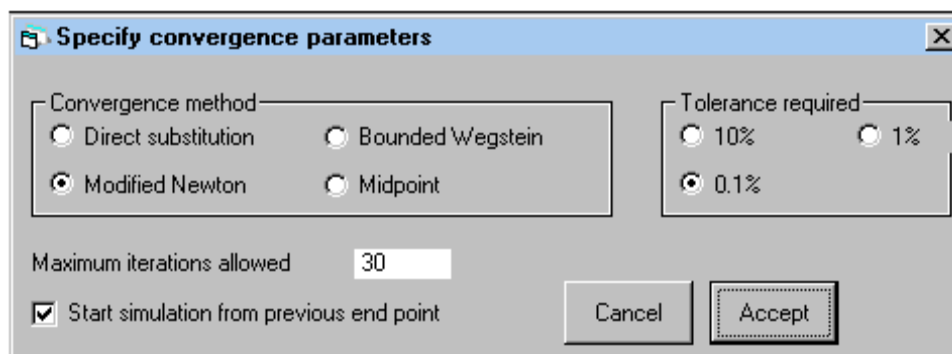
Additional property: Specify here values for any other property that is to be distributed over s-classes for subsequent use in any unit model.

NOTE: It is not necessary to specify values for more than one property for distribution over the S-classes but if S-classes are to have any influence in any of the models, at least one property must be specified. If the number of S-classes is specified as 1 on the system data form (Form 4), then it is obviously not possible to specify properties for S-classes. See section 10.1 *Accessing System Data in the Model Subroutines* for information on how to access this data in any model subroutines that you write.

Data set: This form allows you to display the default data set, the current data set in the simulator and the new data set that is under construction and to switch among these data sets.

4.4 Setting the Convergence Properties

MODSIM provides two different methods to improve the rate of convergence of the iterative calculation: direct substitution and modified Newton. The convergence characteristics of the computation can be specified on this form.

A screenshot of a Windows-style dialog box titled "Specify convergence parameters". The dialog has a blue title bar with a close button (X) in the top right. Inside, there are two groups of radio buttons. The first group, labeled "Convergence method", contains four options: "Direct substitution", "Bounded Wegstein", "Modified Newton" (which is selected with a black dot), and "Midpoint". The second group, labeled "Tolerance required", contains three options: "10%", "0.1%" (which is selected with a black dot), and "1%". Below these groups is a text field labeled "Maximum iterations allowed" containing the number "30". At the bottom left is a checked checkbox labeled "Start simulation from previous end point". At the bottom right are two buttons: "Cancel" and "Accept".

Form 7 Form to specify the convergence method that is to be used for the simulation. This form is entered by clicking the **Set convergence properties** control on the system data form.

Convergence method: Select the desired convergence method from the four methods. The Modified Newton method is preferred but sometimes its radius of convergence can be quite small and direct substitution is more robust but generally slower. Bounded Wegstein and midpoint convergence can be tried when convergence appears to be oscillatory but they tend to be very slow. It is always possible that the data specified for the unit models may produce a plant set up that has no finite steady state solution. Persistent lack of convergence is usually an indication of this condition and you will need to examine your models very carefully to ensure that they do produce physically realistic outputs.

Tolerance required: Select the required tolerance for the iterative calculation.

Maximum number of iterations: In case convergence is difficult, the total number of iterations are limited to the number specified in this field.

Start simulation from previous end point: when a flowsheet contains recycle streams it is necessary to decompose the flowsheet for sequential calculation. This is done internally in MODSIM by using tear streams. At the start of the calculation these streams are virtually torn open and initial trial values for the flowrates of each of the particle types are assigned. These are the starting values for the iterative calculation. When the simulation ends the final values of these flowrates are recorded so that they are available as starting values for the next calculation. This usually reduces the number of iterations required for convergence of the iterative calculation and can save significant amounts of time especially if the simulation is run on slower machines. This is the default condition.

If the calculation terminates abnormally, these starting values may be inappropriate or the set of values may be incomplete. Under these circumstances, the simulation should not start at the previous end point and this box should not be checked.

5 SPECIFYING THE DATA IN THE PLANT FEED STREAMS

The feed streams to the plant must be completely specified with respect to their flowrates,

Particle-size distribution and feed rate in feed streams

Specify a descriptive name for the stream

Mesh size	% Passing
Infinity	100.00
5.000E-3	99.97
3.536E-3	99.49
2.500E-3	96.93
1.768E-3	89.95
1.250E-3	78.03
8.839E-4	63.21
6.250E-4	48.30
4.419E-4	35.29
3.125E-4	24.96
2.210E-4	17.26
1.562E-4	11.75
1.105E-4	7.92
7.812E-5	5.30
5.524E-5	3.53
3.906E-5	2.34
2.762E-5	1.55
1.953E-5	1.03
1.381E-5	.68
9.766E-6	.45

Clear

Stream number 1 Stream name Plant feed

Number of mesh sizes in your data 20

Units of size: ☐ micron ☐ mm ☐ cm ☒ m ☐ inch

☐ New ☐ Current ☐ Default

☐ Use Rosin-Rammler distribution

Feed rate 2.778E+1 Percent solids 100.00

Units of feed rate: ☒ kg/s ☐ Short tons/hr ☐ tonnes/hr ☐ Long tons/hr

Specify grade distributions

Specify distribution over S-classes

Cancel Accept

Form 8 Form to specify the particle size distribution and the feed rate of a feed stream. A separate form must be filled for each feed stream in the flowsheet. The form is entered by double clicking on the system data form (Form 3)

composition and size distribution. These specifications are made using the feed stream form.

Stream: The number of the stream in the flowsheet is specified here. You can allocate a descriptive name to the stream to assist identification of the stream data from the simulator. The name that is specified here is transferred to the feed stream field in the system data form. Stream names must start with an alphabetic character.

Number of sizes: Specify here the number of mesh sizes that are available in the distribution data for this stream. This need not be the same as the number specified on the system data form.

Size: List the mesh sizes that define the size distribution for this stream.

%Passing: Specify the cumulative size distribution as percent passing the mesh size.

Units of size: The mesh sizes can be specified in any of the common units that are listed. Check the unit of size that you use. Use a left mouse click to select a unit of size. Use a right mouse click to convert existing sizes to a new unit.

Use Rosin-Rammler distribution: If the size distribution in the stream is not known a Rosin-Rammler distribution can be used by checking this box. The parameters in the Rosin-Rammler distribution can be specified in the following fields.

D63.2: Specify the 63.2% passing size for the distribution.

Lambda: Specify the exponent of the distribution.

Feed rate: Specify the feedrate of solids in this stream. Check the appropriate units used in **Units of feedrate** field. Use a left mouse click to select a unit of size. Use a right mouse click to convert existing sizes to a new unit.

Percent solids: Specify the percent solids in this stream.

Specify grade distributions: Define the mineralogical composition of this stream by specifying the distribution of particles over the grade classes. Click on this control to bring up the grade class distribution form.

Specify distribution over s-classes: If s-classes have been requested click this control to bring up the s-class distribution form.

Clear: This control has two functions: click it to clear the size distribution fields if you want to respecify the entire distribution; click this button to generate the Rosin-Rammler distribution if the R-R distribution has been selected.

Data set: This form allows you to display the default data set, the current data set in the simulator and the new data set that is under construction and to switch among these data sets.

5.1 Specify the Distribution over Grade Classes

The mineralogical composition of the solids in any stream is defined by specifying the distribution of particles over the grade classes that are being used. The composition can vary from size to size and this form allows the distribution to be specified for many size ranges depending on what data is available.

Mass fraction: Specify the fraction by mass of the total amount of solid in the size interval selected that is allocated to each grade class.

Size range: The distribution over the grade classes is specific to a size interval — smaller particle are in general more completely liberated than larger particles — so a separate distribution must be specified for each size interval. The size intervals are specified as contiguous size ranges. The default is a single size range from zero to the maximum size that is specified on the system data form. To increase or decrease the number of size intervals, edit the upper or lower size of any subrange.

S-Class number	Fraction
1	.9
2	.05
3	.05

Grade class for this distribution

1 2

Form 9 Form for the specification of the distribution over the S-classes. A separate form must be filled for each feed stream in the flowsheet. This form is entered by clicking the **Specify distribution over S-classes** control on the feed stream form. (Form 8).

Import data from file: The distribution data can be imported from an external ASCII file. This happens for example when the liberation spectrum of the material in the stream has been determined by image analysis at a number of sizes and the distribution results from a stereological correction program. The format of the ASCII file is

Data set: This form allows you to display the default data set, the current data set in the simulator and the new data set that is under construction and switch among these data sets.

5.2 Specify the Distribution over the S-classes

The distribution over the s-classes is specified as the mass fraction in each s-class.

Fraction: The distribution is specified as fraction by mass.

Grade class for this distribution: Each grade class has its own s-class distribution. Click the number of the grade class to which this distribution refers. You must select each grade class before leaving this form. Those classes not selected will be assigned the default distribution.

Clear: Click this control to clear the distribution fields.

Form 10 Form to specify the distribution of particles over the grade classes in the feed stream that is identified in the **stream** field. A separate form must be filled for each feed stream in the flowsheet. This form is entered by clicking the **Specify grade distributions** control on the feed stream form (Form 8).

Data set: This form allows you to display the default data set, the current data set in the simulator and the new data set that is under construction.

5.3 Specify Water Feeds

Any water feeds to the plant must be specified.

Stream: The number of the stream in the flowsheet is displayed. A descriptive name for the stream can be specified.

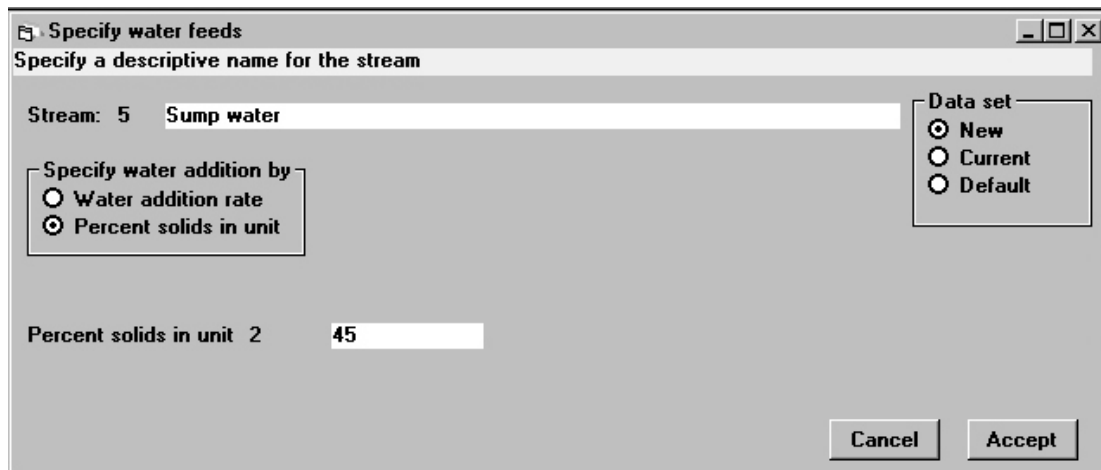
Specify water addition by: The water addition rate can be specified in one of two ways. The rate can be specified as a fixed rate of addition or the required percent solids in the stream leaving the unit that takes the water feed can be specified. In the

latter case, MODSIM will adjust the water addition rate to ensure that the required percent solids in the outlet stream from the unit is achieved.

Water addition rate: Specify the water rate.

Units for the flow rate: Click the appropriate units.

Percent solids in unit: Specify the required percent solids required in the unit indicated.



Form 11 Form to specify water addition rates. This form is entered by double-clicking the stream in the **Water addition streams** field on the system data form (Form 3).

Data set: This form allows you to display the default data set, the current data set in the simulator and the new data set that is under construction and to switch among these data sets.

5.4 Specifying Data for Internal Flow Streams

If you have experimental data that describes the size distributions and the liberation spectra in any internal streams in the plant, these can be displayed on the output graphs for comparison with the simulator output. The simulator will not use the data directly and it is available only for comparison purposes. These data can be specified through forms 8 and 9. These forms are accessed for this purpose by double clicking the appropriate stream number in the **Internal and product streams** field on Form 3. If no size distribution data are available, the number of sizes should be set to 1 in Form 8. When specifying grade class-data for internal and product streams on Form 9 only composite data over all particle sizes is allowed and not distributions for separate particle sizes. Internal and product streams can be given descriptive names using Form 8.

6 SPECIFYING PARAMETERS FOR THE UNIT MODELS

Most of the models that are incorporated in MODSIM require one or more parameters to

MODSIM - Select models and parameters for units

Double click a model to select it

Job Name: ex1bV3

Unit number	Unit type
1	Vibrating screen
2	Mixer
3	Sieve bend
4	Dewatering screen
5	Dense-medium cyclone
6	Mixer
7	Mixer
8	Coal washing unit
9	Mixer
10	Water-only cyclone
11	Sump
12	Mixer
13	Mixer
14	Pass-through unit

Models

- SCRN
- SCR1
- SCR2
- CYCA
- PSCN

☐ Help

CANCEL ACCEPT

Form 12 Selection of units for specification of unit parameters. This form is entered by executing **Unit parameters** on the main menu.

be specified so that the model will describe the unit as it is set up in the flowsheet. Parameter specification is done through forms that are specifically designed for the purpose. The **Unit parameters** entry on the main menu will bring up a form for the selection of units for parameter specification. This is shown as Form 12.

Fields on Form 12 have the following significance.

Unit number Unit type A list of unit numbers from the flowsheet and the corresponding type of unit. A single click on any unit in this field will display the list of models that are currently available in MODSIM for the selected unit. The list of models is displayed in the **Models** list.

Models A list of models that are currently available for the unit that is selected in the **Unit type** list. Double click on the model to choose it for the unit. The parameter specification form for that model will be brought up. The model that appears at the top of the list is the one that is currently selected for the unit.

Help If the help box is checked, double clicking the model name will display the help screen for the chosen model. This screen will present a brief description of the model and will explain the significance of each of the parameters in the model.

7 THE UNIT MODELS

At the heart of MODSIM are the unit models. The simulator is only as good as the models that it contains. If any model does not accurately describe the operation of the unit the simulator can not give a reliable picture of the behavior of the plant. Models must be chosen with care and for accurate work they should be carefully calibrated against appropriate experimental data.

A brief description of each of the unit models that are supplied as standard is given in this section.

7.1 Comminution Models

7.1.1 Crushers

JAW1: Simple model for a jaw crusher.

This model produces a size distribution in the product that is of standard type which is independent of the size distribution in the feed except that the crusher cannot discharge material in size classes that have size larger than the largest size in the feed.

The standard size distribution that is assumed is taken from NORDBERG PROCESS MACHINERY REFERENCE MANUAL May 1976

PARAMETERS

1...Open-side setting.

2...Impact work index of the material in this unit.

The form for specifying these parameters is shown as Form 13

JAW2: Simple model for a jaw crusher.

This model produces a size distribution in the product that is of standard type which is independent of the size distribution in the feed except that the crusher cannot discharge

Form 13 Parameter input form for jaw crusher models **JAW1** and **JAW2**

material in size classes that have size larger than the largest size in the feed.

The standard size distribution that is assumed is from Samancor's Mamatwan plant.

PARAMETERS.

1...Open-side setting.

2...Impact work index of the material in this unit.

The form for specifying these parameters is shown as Form 13

GYRA: Model for the gyratory crusher.

This model assumes that the size distribution in the product is of standard type. This means that the size distribution of the product is determined entirely by the open-side setting of the crusher and does not depend on the size distribution of the feed.

The shape of the size distribution is determined from data in the Nordberg Process Machinery Reference Manual May 1976.

PARAMETERS

1...Open side setting in meters.

2..."Material type" -slabby, tough, brittle or spongy.

3...Impact work index of the material.

The form for specifying these parameters is shown as Form 14

Specify parameters for model GYRA

Open side setting: ☒ cm ☐ m ☐ inch

Work index: ☐ kW/hr/tonne ☒ kW/hr/shrt ton

Ore type: ☒ Brittle ☐ Tough ☐ Slabby

Ore type: ☒ Average ☐ Slabby

Ore type: ☒ Average ☐ Spongy

Data set: ☒ New ☐ Current data ☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 14 Form to specify parameters for model **GYRA**.

EMJC: Empirical Model for Jaw and Gyratory Crushers.

This model is based on reference Csoke B, Petho S, Foldesi J. and Meszaros. Optimization of stone-quarry technologies. Intl. Jnl. of Mineral Processing 44-45 (1996) 447 - 459.

The model is based on the idea that material in the feed smaller than the gap passes

MODSIM - Parameter specification
Specify parameters for model EMJC

Crusher gap: .0254

Largest size in product as a multiple of the gap rmax: 1.251

Exponent m: .843

Work index of the material in this crusher: 12

Units of size: ☐ micron ☐ mm ☐ cm ☒ m ☐ inch ☐ feet

Data set: ☐ New ☐ Current ☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 15 Form to specify parameters for model **EMJC** — empirical model for jaw crushers.

straight through the crusher and the larger material is crushed to a predefined size distribution that is modeled by

$$P(r) = \left(\frac{r}{r_{\max}} \right)^m$$

$$r = \frac{d_p}{\text{Gap}}$$

$$r_{\max} = \frac{d_{p \max}}{\text{Gap}}$$

PARAMETERS

1...Crusher gap

2... $r_{\max}$

3...Coefficient m

4...Impact work index of the material in this crusher

The form for specifying these parameters is shown as Form 15

CRSH: Standard model for a crusher.

This model can be used for jaw crushers, gyratory crushers and cone crushers. The default

MODSIM - Parameter specification
Specify parameters for model CRSH

Closed-side set	.0254
Proportion of fines produced during a breakage event K	.2
Impact work index of the material kWhr/tonne	12
Proportionality constant between CSS or OSS and d1 - Alpha1	.653
Proportionality constant between CSS or OSS and d2 - Alpha2	1.6

Units of size

☐ micron
 ☐ mm
 ☐ cm
 ☒ m
 ☐ inch
 ☐ feet

Data set

☐ New
 ☐ Current
 ☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 16 Form to specify parameters for model **CRSH**

data is for a Symons standard cone crusher. This model is based on the crushing zone and internal classification behavior described by Whiten et. al. The classification action is modeled by

$$\begin{aligned}
 c_i &= 1 - \left(\frac{d_{pi} - k_2}{k_1 - k_2} \right)^{k_3} && \text{for } k_1 < d_{pi} < k_2 \\
 &= 0 && \text{for } d_{pi} < k_1 \\
 &= 1 && \text{for } d_{pi} > k_2
 \end{aligned}$$

The values of k_1 and k_2 are related to the closed-side setting by

$$\begin{aligned}
 k_1 &= \alpha_1 \times \text{CSS} \\
 k_2 &= \alpha_2 \times \text{CSS}
 \end{aligned}$$

The breakage function is modeled by

$$B(x,y) = (1 - K) \left(\frac{x}{y} \right)^n + K \left(\frac{x}{y} \right)^m$$

References:

1 Whiten W J The simulation of crushing plants with models developed using multiple spline regression. Application of Computer methods in the Mineral industry. Eds MDG Salamon and Lancaster. S. Afr. Inst. Min. Metall. Johannesburg, 1973. P317-323

2 Whiten WJ, Walter GW, and White ME, A Breakage function suitable for crusher models. 4TH TEWKSBURY SYMPOSIUM, MELBOURNE, FEB 1973 P19.1-19.32

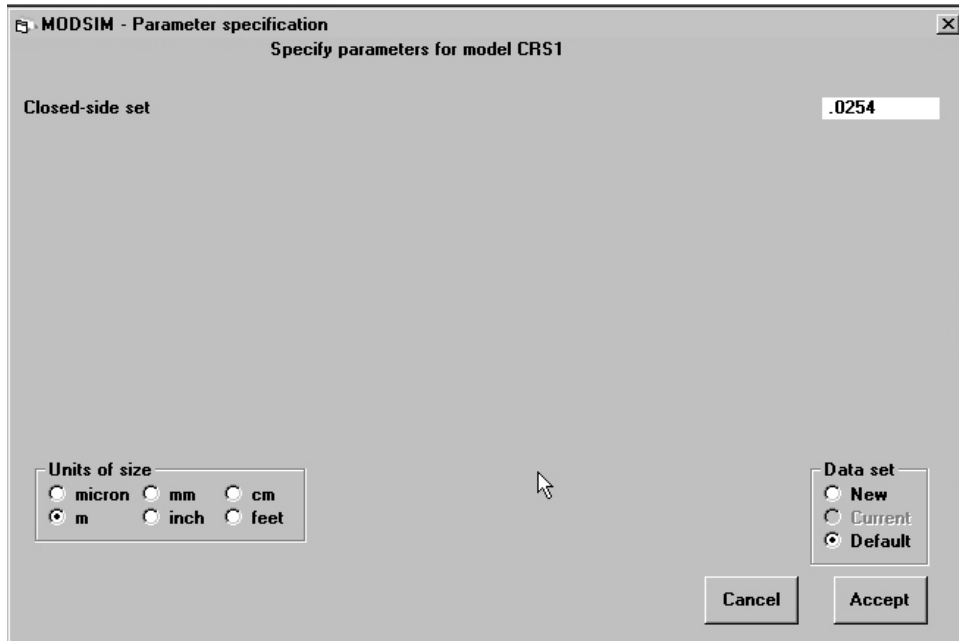
Breakage and classification functions were taken from reference 2.

PARAMETERS

- 1...Closed side setting for cone crushers, open side setting for gyratory or jaw crushers.
- 2...Proportion of fines produced during breakage events.
- 3...Impact work index of the material.
- 4...Factor for classification parameter k_1
- 5...Factor for classification parameter k_2

The form for specifying these parameters is shown as Form 17

CRS1: Model for a Symons cone crusher.



Form 17 Parameter input form for crusher model **CRS1**.

This model should be used only for preliminary calculations. The size distribution in the product is assumed to be of the standard type and is therefore independent of the size distribution in the feed. The standard size distribution is taken from the Nordberg Process Machinery Reference manual MAY 1976

PARAMETER

1...Closed side setting.

The form for specifying these parameters is shown as Form 17.

SHHD: Short-head crusher

This model is based on the crushing zone and internal classification behavior described by Whiten et. al. The parameters in the model were determined by V J Karra - see reference 3 below.

References:

1 Whiten W J The simulation of crushing plants with models developed using multiple spline regression. Application of Computer methods in the Mineral industry Eds MDG Salamon and Lancaster. S. Afr. Inst. Min. Metall. Johannesburg, 1973. P317-323

- 2 Whiten WJ, Walter GW, and White ME, A Breakage function suitable for crusher models. 4TH TEWKSBURY SYMPOSIUM, MELBOURNE, FEB 1973 P19.1-19.32
- 3 Karra V K. A process performance model for cone crushers. PROC. 15th INT. MINERAL PROCESSING CONGRESS. TORONTO. CAN. INST. MIN. METALL. 1982. pp III-6.1 - III-6.14.

MODSIM - Parameter specification
Specify parameters for model SHHD

Closed-side set	.0254
Proportion of fines produced during a breakage event K	.2
Impact work index of the material kWhr/tonne	12
Alpha1	.653
Alpha2	2

Units of size

☐ micron ☐ mm ☐ cm
☒ m ☐ inch ☐ feet

Data set

☐ New
☐ Current
☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 18 Form to specify parameters for the model **SHHD** for short head crushers.

PARAMETERS

- 1...Closed side setting in meters.
- 2...Proportion of fines produced during breakage events.
- 3...Impact work index of the material.
- 4...Factor for classification parameter k1
- 5...Factor for classification parameter k2

7.1.2 Grinding Mills

FAGM: Fully autogenous mill.

Fully autogenous mill modeled using the full population balance including particle attrition and wear as developed by Austin and Hoyer. See Modeling and Simulation of Mineral

Processing Systems Section 5.10. Three distinct breakage processes are modeled: surface attrition, impact breakage and self breakage.

Specify parameters for model FAGM

Parameters for selection function:

Selection function at 1mm 1/min	.3994
Alpha	.5
Mu in mm	10
Lambda	2.513

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta	3.723
Gamma	.748
Delta	0
Phi at 5mm	.72

Mill dimensions:

Mill diameter m	5
Load volume %	.4
Mill speed %critical	75
Grate opening mm	.02

T10 parameter A: 50
T10 parameter b: 1

Largest size for attrition products mm: .001
Attrition parameter Ta: 1

Residence time in the mill mins: 20

Data set:
☐ New
☐ Current data
☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 19 Form to specify parameters for model FAGM for a fully autogenous mill.

The rate of attrition can be measured using a tumbling test such as that described in Napier-Munn *et. al.* Mineral Comminution Circuits. Their Operation and Optimization. JKMRB Brisbane 1996. and Goldman M and Barbery G. "Wear and Chipping of Coarse Particles in Autogenous Grinding: Experimental Investigation and Modeling". Minerals Engineering. 1(1988)67-76. Goldman M, Barbery G, and Flament F. "Modeling load and Product Distribution in Autogenous and Semi-Autogenous Mills: Pilot-Plant Tests". CIM Bulletin Vol 84 No 946 Feb 1991 pp80-86. The attrition parameter Ta is 1/10 of the height of the plateau on the cumulative size distribution plot of the attrition products after tumbling 46 mm lumps for 10 minutes.

Impact fracture is modeled using the standard Austin breakage and selection functions. See Austin LG, Barahona CA, Menacho JM. "Investigations of Autogenous and Semi-Autogenous Grinding in Tumbling Mills". Powder Technology 51(1987) 283-294.

Rate of self breakage is modeled using the variation of fracture energy and the consequent breakage probability. The average kinetic energy of impact is determined assuming the lumps fall a fraction of the mill diameter. The selection function for self breakage on impact is modeled by calculating the rate of breakage as the number of drops of lumps of size d_p per second $\times$ mass of lump $\times$ probability of breakage. All drops are assumed to be $0.5 \times$ mill diameter. The distribution of drop heights from DEM simulations will be incorporated in a later version of this model. The breakage probability is modeled on the measured particle fracture energy reported by Tavares and King "Application of Thermal Treatment to improve Comminution" SME Annual Meeting Denver 1995 95-238 with later

modifications to reflect measurements on wider range of materials. The median particle fracture energy varies with particle size according to

$$E_{50} = 56 \left(1 + \frac{0.001}{d_p} \right)^2$$

The breakage function for self breakage is based on C Leung, Morrison and Whiten Copper '87 who recommend the T_{10} breakage function model with parameters determined using a dual pendulum or drop weight test. T_{10} is modeled as a function of impact energy using a simple exponential function. Two parameters A and b are used to describe this function. These are ore-specific and MODSIM requires them as unit parameters.

$$T_{10} = A(1 - e^{-bECS})$$

The parameter b is proportional to the median particle fracture energy of the material and consequently is a function of particle size. ECS is the mass specific energy absorbed during breakage in kWhr/tonne. The energy is related to the height of fall and therefore proportional to the mill diameter.

Breakage function for products from abrasion in the autogenous mill is modeled using data from Leung K, Morrison RD and Whiten WJ. "An Energy-Based Ore-Specific Model for Autogenous and Semi-Autogenous Grinding". Copper 87 Santiago, Chile, Universidad de Chile (1987-1988) pp71-85

The mill is assumed to be perfectly mixed with post classification at the grate.

This model permits the use of a pseudo stream from the mill to report the size distribution of the mill load.

PARAMETERS

Impact breakage:

Parameters for breakage function

Beta

Gamma

Delta

Phi at 5mm

Parameters for selection function

Selection function at 1 mm

Alpha

Mu

Lambda

Self breakage:

Parameters for variation of T10 with impact energy

A

b

Attrition

Largest size for attrition products

Attrition parameter Ta

Mill parameters

Mill diameter

Mill filling

Mill speed

Grate aperture

Residence time

SAGM: Semi-autogenous mill

Semi autogenous mill modeled using the full population balance including particle attrition and wear as developed by Austin and Hoyer. See Modelling and Simulation of Mineral Processing Systems Section 5.10. Austin L G, J M Menacho and F Percy. "A general model for semi-autogenous and autogenous milling". APCOM 87 Proc 20th Intl Symp on the Application of Computers and Mathematics in the Mineral Industries. Vol 2 SAIMM Johannesburg 1987 pp 107 - 126. L G Austin, C A Barahona and J M Menacho "Investigations of autogenous and semi-autogenous grinding in tumbling mills" Powder Technology 51 (1987) 283 - 294. Three distinct breakage processes are modeled: surface attrition, impact breakage and self breakage. See model FAGM for more details.

Specify parameters for model SAGM

Parameters for selection function measured in test mill:		Test mill dimensions:	
Selection function at 1mm 1/min	1	Mill diameter m	.2
Alpha	.95	Load volume %	20
Mu in mm	1.65	Mill speed %critical	75
Lambda	3.3	Ball diameter mm	25
T10 parameter A %		Mill dimensions (inside liners):	
T10 parameter b tonnes/kW hr	1	Mill diameter m	8
Largest size for attrition products mm	2	Center line length m	6
Attrition parameter Ta	1	Belly length m	4
		Trunnion diameter m	2
		Load volume %	35
		Ball volume %	10
		Ball size mm	50
		Mill speed %critical	72
		Grate opening mm	40

Data set:
☐ New
☐ Current data
☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 20 Form to specify parameters for SAG mill model SAGM.

Goldman M and Barbery G. "Wear and Chipping of Coarse Particles in Autogenous Grinding: Experimental Investigation and Modeling". Minerals Engineering. 1(1988)67-76 Goldman M, Barbery G, and Flament F. "Modeling load and Product Distribution in Autogenous and Semi-Autogenous Mills: Pilot-Plant Tests". CIM Bulletin Vol 84 No 946 Feb 1991 pp80-86 Impact fracture is modeled using the standard Austin breakage and selection functions. See Austin LG, Barahona CA, Menacho JM. "Investigations of Autogenous and Semi-Autogenous Grinding in Tumbling Mills". Powder Technology 51(1987) 283-294. The parameters for the selection function are assumed to be available from a small scale ball mill test. Scale up is based on the size distribution and densities of the autogenous media which is defined as all lumps larger than the grate aperture size. Due allowance is made for the volume fraction and density of the media and balls.

Rate of self breakage is modeled using the variation of particle fracture energy and the consequent breakage probability with size. The average kinetic energy on impact is determined assuming the lumps fall a fraction of the mill diameter. The mill is assumed to be perfectly mixed with post classification at the grate. The load in the mill is calculated from the mill dimensions and the average residence time calculated as the ratio of the load to the throughput. The power drawn by the mill is determined using formulas of Austin and Morrell. This model permits the use of a pseudo stream from the mill to carry the size distribution of the mill load. Water can be added directly to the mill feed at a prespecified rate or the simulator will

calculate the water addition rate that is required to achieve a specified solid content in the mill discharge.

PARAMETERS:

Impact breakage Parameters for selection function determined in a small scale ball mill:

- Selection function at 1 mm

- Alpha

- Mu

- Lambda

Self-breakage breakage function: T10 model used

- A

- b

Attrition:

- Largest size for attrition products

- Attrition parameter Ta

Test mill parameters:

- Test mill diameter

- Test mill filling

- Test mill speed

- Ball size

SAG mill dimensions:

- Diameter

- Center line length

- Belly length

- Trunnion diameter

- Load volume

- Ball volume

- Ball size

- Mill speed

- Grate aperture

RODM: Rod mill

Specify parameters for model RODM

Parameters for selection function:

Selection function at 1mm	0.3994
Alpha	0.5
Mu in mm	10
Lambda	2.513

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta	3.723
Gamma	0.748
Delta	0
Phi at 5mm	0.72

Residence time of water: 5

Exponential coefficient for decrease of velocity with size: 1

Data set:

- ☐ New
- ☐ Current data
- ☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 21 Form to specify parameters for the model **RODM** for rod mills.

This model is based on plug flow of the charge through the rod mill. Solids move through the mill in plug flow but the longitudinal transport velocity varies with particle size. Larger particles move more slowly than smaller particles and solids move slower than the water except particles in the last class which move with the water.

The velocity distribution is modeled by

$$v(d_p) = v_w \exp\left(-c \frac{d_p}{d_{p1}}\right)$$

The model structure is defined by

$$v_i \frac{dm_i}{dx} + S_i m_i = \sum_{j=1}^{i-1} b_{ij} S_j m_j$$

The residence time of the water must be specified.

Parameters:

- 1...alpha
- 2...beta
- 3...gamma

- 4...delta
- 5...A (close to selection function at 1mm)
- 6...phi at 5mm (phi5)
- 7...Mean residence time in the mill (mins)
- 8...mu
- 9...lambda
- 10...Coefficient c for variation of transport velocity with particle size.

References:

1. Rogovin Zvi, Casali Aldo and Herbst JA. Tracer study of mass transport and grinding in a rod mill. Intl Jnl of Mineral Processing 22(1988) 149-167.
2. Austin LG, Klimpel RR and Luckie PT. "Process Engineering of Size Reduction: Ball Milling" SME 1984 p123 et seq.
3. King RP "Modeling and Simulation of Mineral Processing Systems" Section 5.9

RODL: Rod mill with liberation

This model is identical to RODM in structure but it includes the model for mineral liberation. Liberation of the mineral phases is computed using the Andrews-Mika model as developed in King R P "Calculation of the Liberation Spectrum in Products Produced in Continuous Milling Circuits". Proc 7th European Symposium on Comminution. Ljubljana June 1990 Vol 2 pp429-444. THIS LIMITS THIS MODEL TO BINARY ORES!!

Claudio Schneider's Beta function model of the internal structure of the Andrew's Mika diagram is available as an alternative liberation model.

Specify parameters for model RODL

Parameters for selection function:

Selection function at 1mm	.3994
Alpha	.5
Mu in mm	10
Lambda	2.513

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta	3.723
Gamma	.748
Delta	0
Phi at 5mm	.72

Residence time of water mins 5

Exponential coefficient for decrease of velocity with size 1

Liberation model

☐ Ljubljana model ☒ Beta function model

Cancel Accept

Data set

☐ New ☐ Current data ☒ Default

Form 22 Form to specify parameters for model RODL for rod mill with liberation.

Parameters:

- 1...alpha
- 2...beta
- 3...gamma
- 4...delta
- 5...A (close to selection function at 1mm)
- 6...phi at 5mm (phi5)
- 7...Mean residence time in the mill (mins)
- 8...mu
- 9...lambda
- 10...Coefficient c for variation of transport velocity with particle size.

MILL: Ball mill

This is the simplest model for the ball mill using the selection and breakage functions. The mill is assumed to consist of a single perfectly mixed region. The selection function is the standard Austin function including the maximum that defines the decrease of the breakage rate as size gets large.

$$S(d_p) = \frac{A d_p^\alpha}{1 + \left(\frac{d_p}{\mu}\right)^\lambda}$$

The breakage function is not necessarily normalized and is also of the standard Austin form.

$$B(x,y) = \varphi \left(\frac{x}{y} \right)^\gamma + (1 - \varphi) \left(\frac{x}{y} \right)^\beta$$

$$\varphi = \varphi_5 \left(\frac{y}{5\text{mm}} \right)^{-\delta}$$

Specify parameters for model MILL

Parameters for selection function:

Selection function at 1mm	.3994
Alpha	.5
Mu in mm	10
Lambda	2.513

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta	3.723
Gamma	.748
Delta	0
Phi at 5mm	.72

Residence time in the mill mins 5

Data set

- ☐ New
- ☐ Current data
- ☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 23 Form to specify parameters for model MILL for autogenous, rod and ball mills.

The breakage function is normalized if $\delta = 0.0$

No scale-up relationships are provided and liberation is not modeled. The mean residence time of the solids must be given.

The model does not need any details of the mill geometry.

PARAMETERS:

1... α

2... β

3... γ

4... δ

5...A (close to selection function at 1mm)

6... ϕ at 5mm (ϕ_5)

7...Mean residence time in the mill (mins)

8... μ

9... Λ

References:

1. Austin LG Chap.7 of "Grinding - Theory and practice" School notes S.Afr.Inst. Min. Metall. Johannesburg. 1977
2. Austin LG and Weller KR. Simulation and scale-up of wet ball milling. Proc 14th Int. Mineral Processing Congress. PDR Maltby (Ed.) Can. Inst. Mining Metall. Montreal (1982) pp I 8.1 - I 8.13
3. Rogers RSC, Shoji K, Hukki AM and Linn. The effect of liner design on the performance of a continuous wet ball mill. Proc 14th Int. Mineral Processing Congress. PDR Maltby (Ed.) Can. Inst. Mining Metall. Montreal (1982) pp I 5.1 - 5.20
4. Austin LG, Kimpel RR and Luckie PT. Process Engineering of Size Reduction: Ball Milling" SME 1984

HFMI: Herbst-Fuerstenau model for the ball mill.

The entire mill is modeled as a single perfectly mixed section. The selection function is modeled using the energy-specific selection function proposed by Herbst and Fuerstenau. (J A Herbst and D W Fuerstenau Intl. Jnl. Mineral Processing 7 (1980) 1-31.) The energy-specific selection function is calculated as a function of particle size using

$$\ln \frac{S^E}{S_1^E} = \zeta_1 \ln d_p + \zeta_2 (\ln d_p)^2 \quad \text{with } d_p \text{ in mm.}$$

where S_1^E is the energy-specific selection function at size 1 mm.

Specify parameters for model HFMI

Net power drawn by mill charge kW 2000

Parameters for selection function:

Energy-specific selection function at 1mm tonnes/kWhr	.8
Zeta 1	.185
Zeta 2	-.312

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta	3.723
Gamma	.748
Delta	0
Phi at 5mm	.72

Data set

☐ New

☐ Current data

☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 24 Form to specify the parameters for model HFMI for ball mills.

The breakage function is the standard Austin model.

This model requires the net power input to the mill charge to be specified and does not require the average residence time to be known.

Water can be added directly to the mill feed at a prespecified rate or the simulator will calculate the water addition rate that is required to achieve a specified solid content in the mill.

Parameters for the selection function:

1... S_1^E in tonnes/kWhr

2... ζ_1

3... ζ_2

Parameters for the breakage function:

4... β

5... γ

6... δ

7... Φ at 5mm

Parameter to define the mill operating condition:

8...Net power drawn by the charge. kW

References:

Herbst J A and Fuerstenau D W. Influence of mill speed and ball loading on the parameters of the batch grinding equation. Trans SME 252 (1972) p169.

Herbst J A and Fuerstenau D W, Mathematical simulation of dry ball milling using Specific power information. Trans SME 254 (1973) p343.

Herbst J A and Fuerstenau D W, Scale-up procedure for continuous grinding mill design using population balance models. International Journal of Mineral Processing, 7 (1980) 1-31.

Herbst J A, Lo Y C and Rajamani R K , Population balance model predictions of the performance of large-diameter mills. Minerals and Metallurgical Processing, May 1985 p114.

Lo Y C and Herbst J a, Consideration of ball size effects in the population balance approach to mill scale-up. Advances in Mineral Processing. P Somasudaran ED., Soc. Mining Engrs. Inc, Littleton CO 1986, Chapter 2.

Lo Y C and Herbst J A, Analysis of the performance of large-diameter ball mills at Bougainville using the population balance approach. Minerals and Metallurgical Processing, Nov 1988 p221.

HFML: Herbst-Fuertenau model for the ball mill with liberation

Model for a ball mill using three perfectly mixed regions in series. Residence times in the 3 regions is distributed in the proportions 0.0137:0.2123:0.7740 No classification between stages and no post classification at the discharge end. This model should be used when the HOLD-UP in the mill is known.

Liberation of the mineral phases is computed using the Andrews-Mika model as developed by in King R P "Calculation of the Liberation Spectrum in Products Produced in Continuous Milling Circuits". Proc 7th European Symposium on Comminution. Ljubljana June 1990 Vol 2 pp429-444. THIS LIMITS THIS MODEL TO BINARY ORES!!

Claudio Schneider's Beta function model of the internal structure of the Andrews-Mika diagram is available as an alternative liberation model.

The selection function is modeled using the energy-specific selection function proposed by Herbst and Fuerstenau. The energy-specific selection function is calculated as a function of particle size using

$$\ln \frac{S^E}{S_1^E} = \zeta_1 \ln d_p + \zeta_2 (\ln d_p)^2 \quad \text{with } d_p \text{ in mm.}$$

where S_1^E is the energy-specific selection function at size 1 mm.

The breakage function is the standard Austin model. The effect of overfilling is not modeled.

This model requires the net power input to the mill charge to be specified and does not require the average residence time to be known.

Water can be added directly to the mill feed at a prespecified rate or the simulator will calculate the water addition rate that is required to achieve a specified solid content in the mill.

Parameters for the selection function:

1... S_1^E in tonnes/kW hr

2... ζ_1

3... ζ_2

Parameters for the breakage function:

4... β

5... γ

6... δ

Specify parameters for model HFML

Net power drawn by mill charge kW 2000

Parameters for selection function:

Energy-specific selection function at 1mm tonnes/kW hr .8

Zeta 1 .185

Zeta 2 .312

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta 3.723

Gamma .748

Delta 0

Phi at 5mm .72

Data set

☐ New

☐ Current data

☒ Default

Choose a liberation model

☒ Ljubljana ☐ Beta function

Cancel Accept

Form 25 Form to specify the parameters for model HFML for a ball mill with mineral liberation.

7... Φ at 5mm

Parameter to define the mill operating condition:

8...Net power drawn by the charge. kW

9...Liberation model.

HFSU: Herbst-fuerstenau model for the ball mill with scale-up

Herbst-Fuerstenau model for a ball mill with liberation using three perfectly mixed regions in series. No classification between stages and no post classification at the discharge.

This model requires the dimensions of the mill to be specified and the net power draw is calculated using the Morell power draw equation. This model is therefore useful for scale-up calculations.

Form 26 Form to specify the parameters for model HFSU for a ball mill.

The selection function is modeled using the energy-specific selection function proposed by Herbst and Fuerstenau. The energy-specific selection function is calculated as a function of particle size using $S^E = S^E1 \cdot \exp(\text{zeta}1 \cdot \ln(dp/dp1) + \text{zeta}2 \cdot (\ln(dp/dp1))^2)$ where S^E1 is the energy-specific selection function at size $dp1$.

Reference: Herbst J A and Fuerstenau D W Scale-up procedure for continuous grinding mill design using population balance models. International Journal of Mineral Processing 7(1980)1-31

The breakage function is the standard Austin model.

Liberation of the mineral phases is computed using the Andrews-Mika model as developed by in King R P "Calculation of the Liberation Spectrum in Products Produced in Continuous Milling Circuits". Proc 7th European Symposium on Comminution. Ljubljana June 1990 Vol 2 pp429-444. THIS LIMITS THIS MODEL TO BINARY ORES!!

Claudio Schneider's Beta function model of the internal structure of the Andrew's Mika diagram is available as an alternative liberation model.

Water can be added directly to the mill feed at a prespecified rate or the simulator will calculate the water addition rate that is required to achieve a specified solid content in the mill discharge.

Parameters for the selection function:

- 1... S^{E1} in tonnes/kWhr
- 2...Zeta1
- 3...Zeta3

Parameters for the breakage function:

- 4...Beta
- 5...Gamma
- 6...Delta
- 7...Phi at 5mm

Dimensions of the mill:

- 8...Diameter of the mill inside the liners.
- 9...Mill length inside liners.
- 10..Media load in the mill.
- 11..Mill speed as a fraction of critical speed.
- 12..Choice of liberation model. 0 = None, 1 = Ljubljana model. 2 = Beta function model.

GMIL: Ball mill including mineral liberation

Model for a ball mill using three perfectly mixed regions in series. Residence times in the 3 regions are distributed in the proportions 0.0137:0.2123:0.7740. No classification between stages. This model should be used when the RESIDENCE TIME in the mill is known.

Austin models for the selection and breakage functions are used. A selection of previously determined parameters for selection and breakage function are provided. These may be used as they are or modified to suit the application. The user may specify these functions also.

Liberation of the mineral phases is computed using the Andrews-Mika model as developed in King R P "Calculation of the Liberation Spectrum in Products Produced in Continuous Milling Circuits". Proc 7th European Symposium on Comminution. Ljubljana June 1990 Vol 2 pp429-444. THIS LIMITS THIS MODEL TO BINARY ORES!!

Specify the parameters for model GMIL

Residence time in the mill minutes

Data set:
☒ New
☐ Current data
☐ Default

Selection function:

Breakage function:

Specific rate at 1mm	0.356
Alpha	0.491
Mu in mm	10
Lambda	2

Beta	3.2
Gamma	0.52
Delta	0
Phi at 5 mm	0.158

Liberation model:
☐ None ☐ Ljubljana model ☒ Beta function model

☐ Allow for overfilling?

☒ Allow for post classification

Classification function: D50 mm Sharpness index

☒ Compute Andrews-Mika diagram on exit using beta function model.

Cancel Accept

Form 27 Form to specify parameters for model **GMIL**.

Claudio Schneider's Beta function model of the internal structure of the Andrews-Mika diagram is available as an alternative liberation model.

PARAMETERS:

- 1....Total residence time in the mill.
- 2....Used to choose a selection function. The following models are available as standard and are accessed through a drop-down menu.
 - 1 = Standard quartzite
 - 2 = Rogers' function for phosphate
 - 3 = Reed, Brame and Austin scale-up model for coal
 - 4 = Standard Austin model for taconite.
- 3....Used to choose a breakage function. Selected to match the selection function that is chosen.
 - 1 = Standard quartzite
 - 2 = Rogers' function for phosphate
 - 3 = Reed, Brame and Austin scale-up model for coal
 - 4 = Standard breakage function for taconite.
- 4....Hardgrove Grindability Index - used only for coal.
- 5Choice of liberation model.

- 1 = Ljubljana model.
- 2 = Beta function model.

GMI1: Ball mill.

Model for a ball mill using three perfectly mixed regions in series. Residence times in the

Specify the parameters for model GMI1

Hold up in the mill: 10 ☒ Metric tons ☐ Short tons

Data set: ☒ New ☐ Current data ☐ Default

Selection function: Taconite

Breakage function: Taconite

Specific rate at 1mm	1.441
Alpha	1.213
Mu in mm	5.46
Lambda	5.06

Beta	0.5
Gamma	1.329
Delta	0
Phi at 5 mm	0.599

Liberation model: ☒ None ☐ Ljubljana model ☐ Beta function model

☒ Allow for overfilling?

☒ Allow for post classification

Classification function: Logistic D50 mm: 2 Sharpness index: 0.7

☐ Compute Andrews-Mika diagram on exit using beta function model.

Cancel Accept

Form 28 Form to specify parameters for model GMI1 for a ball mill.

3 regions are distributed in the proportions 0.0137:0.2123:0.7740 No classification between stages. This model should be used when the HOLD-UP in the mill is known.

Austin models for the selection and breakage functions are used. A selection of previously determined parameters for selection and breakage function are provided. These may be used as they are or modified to suit the application. The user may specify these functions also.

The model allows for liberation of the mineral phases which is computed using the Andrews-Mika model as developed in King R P "Calculation of the Liberation Spectrum in Products Produced in Continuous Milling Circuits". Proc 7th European Symposium on Comminution. Ljubljana June 1990 Vol 2 pp429-444. THIS LIMITS THIS MODEL TO BINARY ORES!!

Claudio Schneider's Beta function model of the internal structure of the Andrew's Mika diagram is available as an alternative liberation model.

Parameters:

- 1....Hold up in the mill in metric tons.
- 2....Used to choose a selection function. The following models are available as standard from a pop-down menu.
 - 1 = Standard quartzite.
 - 2 = Rogers' function for phosphate.
 - 3 = Reed, Brame and Austin scale-up model for coal.
- 3....Used to choose a breakage function. Selected to match the selection function.
 - 1 = Standard quartzite.
 - 2 = Rogers' function for phosphate.
 - 3 = Reed, Brame and Austin scale-up model for coal.
- 4....Switch for allowing for over filling.
 - 0 = Overfilling does not influence the model.
 - 1 = Overfilling calculated using the Austin model.
- 5....Hardgrove grindability index - only used for coal.
- 6....Choice of liberation model.
 - 1 = Ljubljana model.
 - 2 = Beta function model.

GMSU Model for the ball mill with scale-up

Model for the ball mill with Austin's scale-up procedure. Mixing in the mill is modeled using three perfectly mixed regions in series. No classification between stages. This model should be used when the parameters for the selection and breakage functions have been determined from laboratory batch tests and the dimensions of the full scale mill are known.

Liberation of the mineral phases is computed using the Andrews-Mika model as developed in King R P "Calculation of the Liberation Spectrum in Products Produced in Continuous Milling Circuits". Proc 7th European Symposium on Comminution. Ljubljana June 1990 Vol 2 pp429-444. THIS LIMITS THIS MODEL TO BINARY ORES!!

Claudio Schneider's Beta function model of the internal structure of the Andrew's Mika diagram is available as an alternative liberation model.

Water can be added directly to the mill feed at a prespecified rate or the simulator will calculate the water addition rate that is required to achieve a specified solid content in the mill discharge.

PARAMETERS:

Specify parameters for model GMSU for unit 2

Parameters for selection function in test mill:

Specific rate of breakage at 1mm S1 1/min: 1.3

Particle size exponent alpha: .491

Size coefficient for maximum breakage rate mu mm: 2

Exponent for rate of decrease of selection function Lambda: 2

Mill dimensions:

	Test mill	Full scale mill
Mill diameter	.38	5
Mill length	.38	5.5
Ball load % J	40	40
Fraction of media filled by slurry U	.4	.4
Mill speed % of critical speed Phic	74	74
Make-up ball size mm	18.75	50

Parameters for breakage function:

Beta: 3.2

Gamma: .52

Delta: 0

Phi at 5mm: .158

Fractional residence times:

Perf. Mixed Region 1: .0137

Perf. Mixed Region 2: .2123

Perf. Mixed Region 3: .774

☒ Allow for post classification ☐ Allow for overfilling?

Classification function: D50 mm 2

Logistic

Sharpness index: .75

Transport model: PM PM (PM,CL)

Ball size distribution:

Number of sizes: 1

Ball size	% in charge
22.4	100.00
0.0401	22.54
0.0307	7.71
0.0235	2.64
0.0179	0.9
0.0137	0.31

Units of size: ☒ meters ☐ Feet

☒ Use standard ball size distribution

Choose a liberation model:

☒ None ☐ Ljubljana ☐ Beta function

☐ Make Andrews-Mika diagram on exit using the beta function model.

Cancel Accept

Form 29 Form to specify parameters for model **GMSU**

Selection function parameters:

- 1...Specific rate of breakage at 1mm 1/min
- 2...Particle size exponent alpha
- 3...Size coefficient for maximum breakage mm
- 4...Exponent for fall off of selection function with size in the abnormal breakage region.

Breakage function parameters:

- 5...Beta
- 6...Gamma
- 7...Delta
- 8...Phi at 5mm

Mill dimensions:

- 9...Test mill diameter.
- 10..Test mill length.
- 11..Ball load in test mill.
- 12..Fraction of media filled with slurry in test mill.

- 13..Mill speed of test mill. % of critical.
- 14..Ball size in test mill. mm
- 15..Full size mill diameter.
- 16..Full size mill length.
- 17..Ball load in full size mill. %
- 18..Media filling in full size mill %
- 19..speed of full size mill % of critical.
- 20..Make-up ball size in full size mill. mm
- 21..D50 for post classifier.
- 22..Sharpness index for post classifier.
- 23..Number of ball sizes.
- 24-35 Ball size - fraction pairs.
- 36..Choice of liberation model. 0 = none, 1 = Ljubljana, 2 = Beta function.
- 37..SWITCH FOR ALLOWING FOR OVERFILLING.
- 38..Choice of post classification function. 0 = None, 1 = Logistic,
2 = Rosin-Rammler, 3 = Exponential sum.
- 39..Choice of Transport Model. 0 = pm;pm;pm-cl, 1 = pm;pm;pm;cl,
2 = pm-cl;pm-cl;pm-cl
- 40..Fractional residence time, Region 1
- 41..Fractional residence time, Region 2

UMIL: Ball mill.

Model for a ball mill using three perfectly mixed regions in series. No classification between stages and post-classification is optional. This model allows the critical parameters for the Andrews-Mika diagram to be specified as parameters.

PARAMETERS:

- 1....Residence time in the first perfectly mixed region.
- 2....Residence time in the second perfectly mixed region.
- 3....Residence time in the third perfectly mixed region.
- 4....Functional forms chosen for breakage function and specific breakage rate constant.
1 = 3-parameter breakage function & 4-parameter rate constant without post classification.

2 = 3-parameter breakage function & 4-parameter rate constant with post classification.

Form 30 Form to specify parameters for model **UMIL** for a ball mill.

4 = 4-parameter breakage function & 4-parameter rate constant with post classification.

7.2 Models for Classifiers

CYCL: Plitt's model for the hydrocyclone.

Form 31 Form to specify parameters for model **CYCL** for a hydrocyclone.

This is the hydrocyclone model according to L R Plitt (CIM Bul. Dec. 1976 p. 114). The subroutine calculates the actual classification curve allowing for bypass fraction. The default parameters relate to the standard geometry but any geometrical configuration can be specified. The geometry of the cyclone can be specified as a standard configuration or each dimension can be specified individually.

Roping of the cyclone is tested using the Mular-Jull and the Concha criteria.

The effect of slurry viscosity is modeled by scaling the d_{50} cut size by a factor $(\text{viscosity}/\text{viscosity of water})^{0.35}$ in accordance with the recommendation of S K Kawatra, A K Bakshi and M T Rusesky "The effect of slurry viscosity on hydrocyclone classification" Int. Jnl. of Mineral Processing 48(1996)39-50

Parameters:

1. Cyclone diameter m
2. Vortex-spigot distance as a fraction of cyclone diameters.
3. Inlet diameter as fraction of cyclone diameters.
4. Vortex finder diameter as a fraction of cyclone diameter.
5. Spigot diameter as a fraction of cyclone diameter.
6. Head of feed slurry m .
7. Number of cyclones in parallel.
8. Plitt's calibration parameters for d_{50} .
9. Plitt's calibration parameter for sharpness.
10. Plitt's calibration parameter for the flow split.
11. Viscosity of the slurry
12. Exponent for density variation
13. Slurry density in separating zone. As a fraction of the difference between the carrier fluid and the lightest solid.

The geometry may be specified on the data entry form (Form 31) in absolute units or relatively to the cyclone diameter.

The exponent for the slurry density defines the variation of D50 with particle density. It reflects the flow conditions in the cyclone. If Stokes law applies the exponent is 0.5 as was recommended tentatively by Plitt. However the level turbulence in the cyclone is always high and higher values of the exponent are usually required to match actual performance.

The density of the slurry in the separating zone of the cyclone also has strong influence on the cut point. This density is always between the density of the carrier fluid and the density of the lightest solid component. Enter the fraction of the difference between these two values.

The effect of slurry viscosity is modeled by scaling the d₅₀ cut size by a factor $(\text{viscosity}/\text{viscosity of water})^{0.35}$ in accordance with the recommendation of S K Kawatra, A K Bakshi and M T Rusesky "The effect of slurry viscosity on hydrocyclone classification" Int. Jnl. of Mineral Processing 48(1996)39-50

Roping of the cyclone is tested using the Mular-Jull and the Concha criteria.

References:

Mular AL and Jull NA. The selection of cyclone classifiers, pumps and pump boxes for grinding circuits. In Mular AL and Bhappu RB Eds. MINERAL PROCESSING PLANT DESIGN AIME 2nd Ed 1980 pp376-403.

Concha FA, Barrientos AC Montero J and Sampaio R. "Air core and roping in hydrocyclones". Preprints 8th European Symposium on Comminution, Stockholm May 1994 Vol 2 pp814-823

CYCA: Hydrocyclone.

Description: General empirical model for a classifier as described by Austin, Klimpel and Luckie "Process Engineering of Size Reduction - Ball Milling" SME 1984 p 305.

The corrected partition curve can be modeled by any one of three standard mathematical functions - the exponential sum or Lynch model, the Rosin-Rammler function or the logistic function. These all have the typical S-shape and are characterized by 2 parameters, the corrected d₅₀ and the sharpness index. The sharpness index is d_{25}/d_{75} and therefore varies between 0 and 1. No classification is represented by 0 and 1 is perfect classification. By-pass to underflow can be specified.

If the unit to be modeled is a cyclone or other classifier that depends on terminal settling velocity, separation size will vary with particle density. This variation is modeled as a simple power function with the exponent selectable as a parameter. The exponent should have a value between 0.5 and 1.0, 0.5 corresponding to Stokes' Law and 1.0 corresponding to Newton's Law for the particle drag coefficient.

MODSIM - Specify the parameter values for model CYCA

Short-circuit to underflow

Sharpness index. Range (0-1)

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Cut size ☐ microns ☐ mm ☐ cm ☒ m ☐ inch

Classification function

☒ Allow d50 to vary with density

Parameter for d50 vs density

Cancel Accept

Form 32 Form to specify parameters for the model CYCA for a hydrocyclone.

Parameters:

- 1....By-pass fraction.
- 2....Sharpness index.
- 3....Corrected d_{50} for particle having specific gravity 2.67.
- 4....Exponent for variation of corrected d_{50} with density.
- 5....Choice of model.
 - 1..Exponential-sum or Lynch model
 - 2..Rosin-Rammler model
 - 3..Logistic model

MODSIM - Specify parameters for model DSC1

Upper deck

Mesh size

Transmission efficiency %

Lower deck

Mesh size

Transmission efficiency %

Both decks

Units of size

☐ mm ☐ cm ☒ m ☐ feet

☐ Specify screen dimensions

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 33 Form to specify parameters for model **DSC1** for a double-deck screen.

DSC1: Double-deck screen.

This is the simple ideal model for double deck screening. The model used is identical to that used in SCR2 for single-deck screens. This model should be used only for preliminary simulations before equipment has been chosen. Model can accommodate water sprays.

PARAMETERS:

1. Mesh size on top deck m .
2. Efficiency of transmission of undersize on top deck.
3. Surface water on top deck oversize.
4. Mesh size on lower deck m .
5. Efficiency of transmission of undersize on lower deck.
6. Surface water on lower deck oversize.
7. Dimensions of the screens (optional)
8. Number of screens in parallel.

DSC2: Double-deck screen.

This is the double-deck version of the Karra model SCR2. See above for details of the model.

Specify parameters for model DSC2

Both screens

Angle of inclination: 0 degrees

Width of screen: 1.22

Bulk density of material: 1603

Screen type: 0=resilient 1=woven wire 2=punched steel 1

Number of screens in parallel: 1

Units for screen dimensions: ☒ meter ☐ feet

Units for bulk density: ☒ kg/m³ ☐ lbs/ft³

Data set: ☒ New ☐ Current ☐ Default

Top deck

Mesh size: 50.8

Wire diameter: 9.53

Length of screen: 3.66

Units for mesh size: ☒ mm ☐ inch

Units for wire diameter: ☒ mm ☐ inch

Lower deck

Mesh size: 12.5

Wire diameter: 4.5

Length of screen: 3.66

Cancel Accept

Form 34 Form to specify parameters for model **DSC2** for a double-deck screen.

PARAMETERS:

1. Mesh size on upper deck. m .
2. Mesh size on lower deck. m .
3. Wire diameter on upper deck. m .

4. Wire diameter on lower deck. *m*.
5. Angle of inclination of the deck. *degrees*.
6. Length of top deck. *m*.
7. Width of screen deck. *m*.
8. Bulk density of material. *kg/m³*
9. Screen type.
10. Length of lower deck.
11. Number of screens in parallel.

ELUT: Elutriator

This elutriator model is based on the partition function using the terminal settling velocity as the independent variable. Separation is therefore a function of both particle size and particle velocity.

The logistic model is used for the partition function and the terminal settling velocity for an arbitrary-shaped particle in water is calculate using the Concha-Almendra procedure.

Form 35 Form to specify parameters for model ELUT for an elutriator.

PARAMETERS:

- 1...By-pass fraction.
- 2...Sharpness index.
- 3...V50, separation velocity, average velocity of liquid flow in the separation section of the elutriator. (cm/sec)
- 4...Particle sphericity = surface area of sphere with same volume/surface area of particle. (This can be measured by image analysis.)

PSCN: Probability screen

Probability screen on which the particles are subjected to a separation process which is size sensitive over a wide range of sizes. This type of screening occurs with a relatively steeply inclined screen is subjected to vibrations having a

substantial component perpendicular to the plane of the screen. This contrasts with conventional vibrating screens that have vibrations predominantly in the parallel direction. The main advantage that is claimed for probability screening is the reduction of blinding because near-size material does not penetrate the screen. Probability screening is sometimes associated with the name of Mogensen who patented the principle in 1951 (US Patent 2 512 177). This model can accommodate water sprays. **WARNING!!!!**This model is based on multilinear regression and is very sensitive to the combination of parameters chosen. It is also very sensitive to the feedrate. You should be certain of the parameter values before using this model.

Specify parameters for model PSCN	
Amplitude of vibration (3 - 4.5 mm)	.003
Vibration frequency (10 - 30 Hz)	20
Angle of inclination of screen (18 - 32 deg)	25
Screen vibration throw angle (60 - 92 deg)	60
Screen aperture size (2.36 - 30 mm)	.005
Screen width (0.3 - 0.5 m)	.5
Screen length (1.25 - 2 m)	1.5
Surface water on screen oversize %	5
Number of screens in parallel	1

Units of size:
☐ micron ☐ mm ☐ cm
☒ m ☐ inch

Data set:
☒ New
☐ Current data
☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 36 Form to specify parameters for model **PSCN** for a probability screen

Model Parameters:

- 1..Amplitude of vibration.
- 2..Vibration frequency.
- 3..Angle of inclination of the screen - degrees
- 4..Screen vibration throw angle.
- 5..Screen aperture size.
- 6..Screen width.
- 7..Screen length.
- 8..Surface water on screen oversize.
- 9..Number of screens in parallel.

References: J M Beeckmans and Judy Hill, "Probability screening", Powder Technology 35(1983)263-269
 Chen Rongguang, JM Beekmans, and Chen Qingru, "A convenient correlation for modelling the performance of probability screens", Intl. Jnl. of Mineral Processing, 36(1992)31-40.

Form 37 Form to specify parameters for model **SCRN** for a single-deck vibrating screen.

SCRN: Single-deck vibrating screen.

This is a simple ideal model for screening. The screen cuts at the specified mesh size but a certain fraction of the undersize is carried over the screen. This is defined by the transmission efficiency. Water sprays can be added to the screen.

Parameters:

1. Mesh size m .
2. Efficiency of transmission to undersize.
3. Surface moisture on screen oversize.
4. Dimensions of the screen. (Optional) Check Specify screen dimensions box if you wish to specify the dimensions of the screen.
5. Number of screens in parallel.

SCR1: Single-deck vibrating screen.

Form 38 Form to specify parameters for model **SCR1** for a single-deck vibrating screen.

Description: A model for wet screening as described by R.S.C. Rogers (Powder Tech. 31(1982) 135-137). The classification function is described by

$$e = \frac{x}{x + \exp(\alpha(1 - x^3))}$$

with

$$x = \frac{d_p}{d_{50c}}$$

The short circuit to oversize follows the water split. The actual classification is described by

$$c = 1 - A(1 - e)$$

where A is the water split to undersize.

This model has been found to be effective for wet screening and has been tested for coal slurries on a Derrick high frequency screen.

Parameters:

1. d_{50} in meters.
2. water split to underflow A.
3. efficiency parameter α . Usually in range 0.8 to 4.0.

SCR2: Single-deck vibrating screen.

Description: The screen simulation model developed by V K Karra (CIM Bulletin, April 1979, p. 167-171). This is a true simulation model in that the parameters are required to define the physical characteristics of the screen including the dimensions of the screen and the screen material. The model calculates the screen separation function from the characteristics and tonnage of the feed (which are supplied by the simulator) in relation to the physical description of the screen. Karra developed a procedure that agrees closely with the method used by engineers to assess screen performance. The subroutine produces a report file that gives a comprehensive description of the screen performance including the calculated screening efficiency which is represented by the usual efficiency factors together with an additional factor which accounts for the presence of near-size materials in the feed. An area utilisation factor (AUF) is calculated which is given by

Form 39 Form to specify parameters for model **SCR2** for a single-deck vibrating screen.

$$AUF = \frac{\text{Amount actually transmitted to underflow}}{\text{Theoretical transmission capacity of the screen}}$$

$$= \frac{\text{Tonnage in underflow}}{A.B.C.D.E.F.G_c \times \text{screen area}}$$

A,B,C,D,E and F are the usual capacity factors and G_c is the near-size capacity factor.

This model is effective for checking the performance of an existing screen or for checking the performance of a proposed screen once its dimensions have been established. The AUF gives an immediate indication as to whether the screen has been correctly sized for the application. (A correctly sized screen will have AUF close to unity). The individual efficiency factors indicate any reasons for poor efficiency and will give a guide as to what process changes are required to improve screen efficiency.

PARAMETERS:

1. Mesh aperture m .
2. Wire diameter m .
3. Angle of inclination of the screen. *degrees*.
4. Length of top deck. m .
5. Width of screen. m .
6. Bulk density of materials to be screened. kg/m^3 .
7. Screen type.

8. Number of screens in parallel.

7.3 Models for Dewatering Operations

DWSC: Dewatering screen

Dewatering screen using the model proposed by K L Ng. "Dewatering performance vibrating screens". Proc. Instn Mech Engrs. Part E Journal of Process Mechanical Engineering. 204 (1990) pp73-79.

Undersize solid is carried through the screen in proportion to the water flow.

Parameters:

- 1....Ultimate moisture content of the material (%)
- 2....Mesh size of the screen
- 3....Length of the screen
- 4....Width of the screen
- 5....Angle of inclination (degrees)
- 6....Vibration frequency (rpm)
- 7....Amplitude of vibration

Specify parameters for model DWSC

Screen characteristics

Length of screen	3.5
Width of screen	1
Vibration frequency (rpm)	300
Vibration amplitude	20
Angle of inclination	15 degrees
Angle of vibration relative to screen	45

Mesh characteristics

Mesh size	1
-----------	---

Slurry characteristics

Ultimate moisture content %	7.5
-----------------------------	-----

Data set

☒ New
☐ Current data
☐ Default

Units for screen dimensions

☒ meter ☐ feet

Units for amplitude

☒ mm ☐ inch

Units for mesh size

☒ mm ☐ inch

Cancel Accept

Form 40 Form to specify parameters for model **DWSC** for a dewatering screen.

- 8....Angle of vibration relative to screen surface (degrees)

FILT: Filter.

This is a simple model for the filter. All solids leave in the filter cake. The operation is specified completely when the water content of the filter cake is given.

Parameters

- 1...Percentage of solids in the filter cake.

MODSIM - Parameter specification

Specify parameters for model FILT

Percent solids in the filter cake 75

Data set

☐ New

☐ Current

☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 41 Form to specify parameters for model **FILT** for a filter.

KYNC: Thickener

This model implements the ideal Kynch thickener method for incompressible pulps.

Specify parameters for model KYNC

Diameter of thickener 15 ☒ m ☐ ft

Terminal settling velocity of an isolated floc 10 mm/s

Number of terms in the extended Wilhelm-Naide expression 2

Alpha 1 .01

Beta 1 1.5

Alpha 2 5E-11

Beta 2 5

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 42 Form to specify parameters for thickener model **KYNC**.

The model uses the extended Wilhelm-Naide equation for the settling velocity of the flocculated slurry. A warning is issued if the feed flux is larger than the maximum flux that can be handled by the thickener. If the thickener is overloaded the

concentration of solids in the overflow is estimated. Thickeners should never be operated for extended periods in an overloaded condition.

The graphical representation of the steady state operation is available on completion of the simulation.

Parameters:

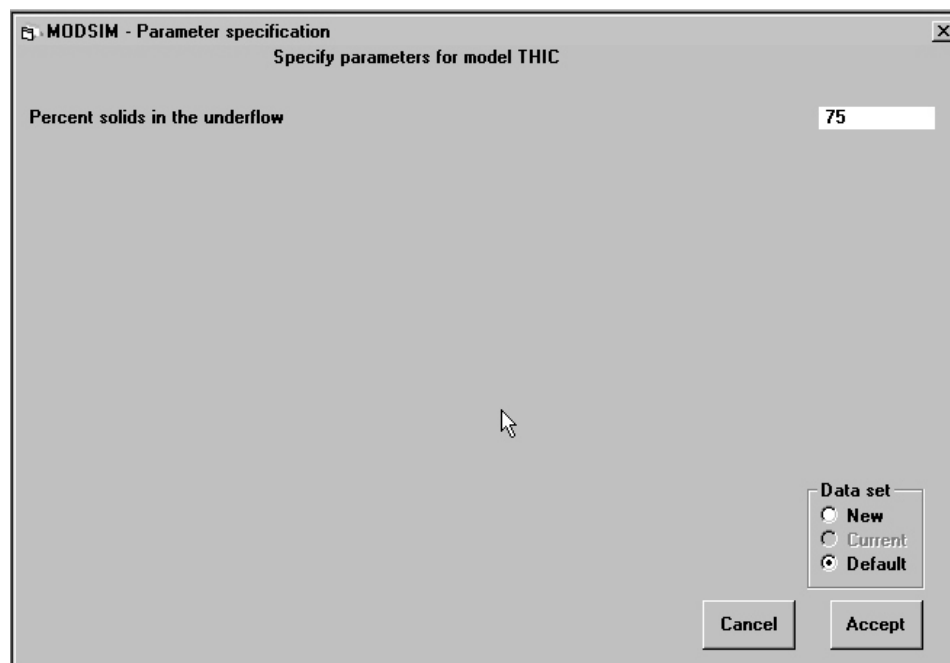
Thickener diameter.

Terminal settling velocity of an isolated floc.

Number of terms in the extended Wilhelm-Naide equation.

Alpha, beta pairs for the extended Wilhelm-Naide equation.

THIC: Thickener.



Form 43 Form to specify parameters for model **THIC** for a thickener.

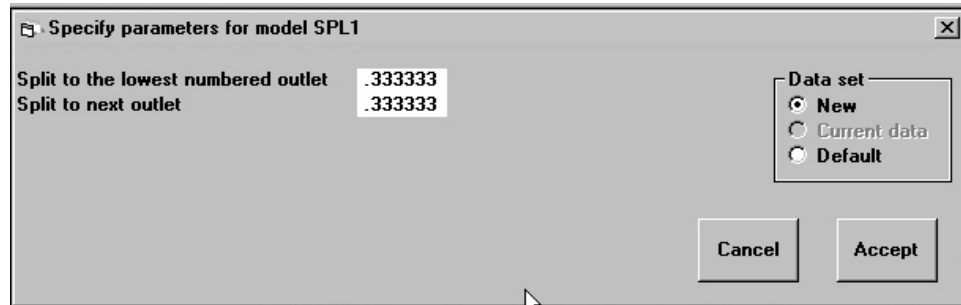
A simple model for the thickener. The model assumes that all solids leave in the underflow.

Parameters

1.....Percentage solids in the underflow.

7.4 Models For Stream Splitters And Mixers

SPLT and **SPL1**: Stream splitters.



Specify parameters for model SPL1

Split to the lowest numbered outlet .333333

Split to next outlet .333333

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 44 form to specify parameters for splitter model **SPL1**.

SPLT

Model splits the feed equally into 2 or 3 streams.

MODSIM determines the number of output streams from the flowsheet.

SPL1

Model splits the feed into 2 or 3 unequal streams.

MODSIM determines the number of output streams from the flowsheet. User must specify the fractional split.

PARAMETERS FOR MODEL SPL1.

- 1....Number of output streams
- 2....Fractional split to output stream 1
- 3....Fractional split to output stream 2

7.5 Models for Concentrating Units

7.5.1 Flotation

Specify parameters for model FLTK		
Specify the specific rate constant for S-class 3		
Number of cells in this bank	2	
Volume of each cell	3	☒ m ³ ☐ ft ³
Aeration rate per unit volume of pulp	1	1/min
Froth transmission coefficient	1	
Average bubble size	2	mm
Bubble residence time	10	sec
Estimated cell residence time	60	sec
Percent solids in the concentrate	40	
Number of banks in parallel	1	
Particle size at maximum recovery	50	micron
Largest floatable particle	1000	micron
Specific flotation rate constants		
k1	0.1	
k2	0.0038	
k3	.000027	
Data set		
☒ New		
☐ Current data		
☐ Default		
Cancel Accept		

Form 45 Form to specify parameters for model FLTK for a bank of flotation cells

FLTK Bank of flotation cells.

This model is the discrete distributed flotation kinetic constant model due to R P King. The true cell residence time is calculated from the tailings flowrate. The percentage solids in the froth is assumed known and this fixes the water balance. The Pogorely model for bubble loading is incorporated so that heavy bubble loads will reduce the flotation capacity in the cell. The froth phase is modeled using the froth transmission coefficient which is defined as the fraction of solid crossing the pulp-froth interface that is actually recovered in the concentrate stream. The remainder of the solid is returned to the pulp phase.

Note that the specific flotation rate constants are mass transfer coefficients because they model the rate of transfer of particulate matter across the phase boundary from pulp to bubble surface. The units of the specific flotation rate constants are therefore m/s.

This model allows water to be added to the concentrate launder so that the solid content of the concentrate that finally leaves the bank is less than the solid content of the concentrate that leaves each cell. The water can be added at a prespecified rate or MODSIM will calculate the addition rate to meet a required final solid content in the concentrate.

Reference: R P King, Model for the design and control of flotation plants.

APCOM 10 (1972) S. Afr. Inst. Min. Metall. Eds Salamon M D G

And Lancaster p.341

Parameters:

- 1....Number of cells in series for this bank.
- 2....Cell volume.
- 3....Aeration rate in m^3 of air per m^3 of cell volume.
- 4....Froth transmission coefficient.
- 5....Bubble size.
- 6....Bubble residence time.
- 7....Estimate of cell holding time.
- 8....Percent solids in the concentrate.
- 9+...Specific flotation rate constants - one for each S-class. Values default to the data set up as system data but different value in each flotation bank are allowed.

FLTN: Bank of flotation cells.

This model is based on the discrete distributed flotation kinetic constant model. The flotation process is modeled as a chemical kinetic process and therefore the specific rate constants must be specified in units of reciprocal time. The volume of pulp in each cell in

Specify parameters for model FLTN

Specify the specific rate constant for S-class 1

Number of cells in this bank	2
Number of banks in parallel	1
Volume of each cell in this bank	10
Solid holdup in kg/m^3 in the cells	400
Air holdup in the cells %	15

☒ m^3 ☐ ft^3

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Specific flotation rate constants in 1/min

k1	1
k2	.065
k3	.00043

Cancel Accept

Form 46 Form to specify parameters for model FLTN for a bank of flotation cells.

the bank must be specified and the pulp residence time is calculated to be consistent with this volume and the tailings flow from the cell.

The water balance is fixed by assuming that the solids holdup per unit volume of pulp is fixed as proposed by D N Sutherland. The residence times of the solid and the water are assumed to be identical.

Reference: Sutherland D N Intl. Jnl. Mineral Processing 4 (1977) 149-162

This model allows water to be added to the concentrate launder so that the solid content of the concentrate that finally leaves the bank is less than the solid content of the concentrate that leaves each cell. The water can be added at a prespecified rate or MODSIM will calculate the addition rate to meet a required final solid content in the concentrate.

Parameters:

- 1....Number of cells in the bank.
- 2....Number of banks in parallel.
- 3...Volume of pulp in each cell m^3
- 4....Solid holdup in kg per cub meter of pulp.
- 5....Air holdup in the cell.
- 6-...Specific flotation rate constants in this bank. One for each S-class. Units are 1/mins. Defaults are the values specified as system data.

KLIM: Klimpel flotation model

The kinetic model for the flotation cell that assumes that each type of particle has a floatable and a non-floatable component. This model is usually associated with Dick Klimpel who made it popular as a simple but useful and consistent model for the comparison of collectors and other conditions in industrial flotation systems. The floatable component of each particle type is recovered at a rate that is proportional to the amount of that species in the flotation cell. The influence of the bubble surface area and the characteristics of the froth phase are neglected entirely. The effect of particle size on the flotation kinetics is also neglected.

The water balance over the cell is established by specifying the percent solids in the concentrate. Water can be added directly to the froth launders in which case the final percent solids in the froth must be specified as well.

Parameters:

Specify parameters for model KLIM

Specify the number of individual cells in this bank

Number of cells in this bank	16
Volume of each cell in this bank	10
Air holdup in the cells %	15
Percent solids in the concentrate	55
Number of banks in parallel	1

☒ m³ ☐ ft³

Data set
☒ New
☐ Current data
☐ Default

Ultimate recovery and kinetic constant for each particle type (G-class)

G-class	Ultimate recovery %	Kinetic constant 1/min
1	90	1
2	90	1

Cancel Accept

- 1.....Number of cells in the bank.
- 2.....Volume of each cell.
- 3.....Volume fraction of air in the pulp.
- 4.....Percent solids in concentrate.
- 5.....Number of banks in parallel.
- 6.....Ultimate recovery for G-class 1.
- 7.....Kinetic constant for G-class 1.
- 8.....Repeat 6 & 7 for each G-class

7.5.2 Gravity Separation Operations

CONE: Reichert cone

Model for the Reichert cone based on the equilibrium stratification model.

The performance of the Reichert cone is modeled using the stratification model. The capacity relationships are based on data provided by Prof E Forssberg of the University of Lulea.

Specify parameters for model CONE

Specific stratification constant

Number of cones in parallel

Data set

- ☒ New
- ☐ Current data
- ☐ Default

Cone configuration and variable slot settings

- ☐ SV
- ☐ DSV
- ☐ 2DSV
- ☐ 3DSV
- ☐ 4DSV
- ☐ DSVSV
- ☐ 2DSVSV
- ☐ 3DSVSV
- ☒ 2DSVSV.DSV

Slot setting for double cones is always 5 and these need not be specified here.

Number of stage concentrates making up the middlings stream

6 6 1 1 1

Cancel Accept

Parameters:

- 1...Specific stratification constant.
- 2...Number of cones in parallel.
- 3...Cone configuration and the slot numbers that define the gaps on each of the single cones in the configuration.

The number of cones that produce middlings product can also be specified.

References:

1. King R P A quantitative model for gravity separation unit operations that rely on stratification. APCOM 87 Proc. 20th Intl Symp. on the Application of Computers and Mathematics in the Mineral Industries. Vol 2 Metallurgy Johannesburg, SAIMM 1987 pp 141 - 151.
2. Forssberg E. and sandstrom E. Utilization of thr REichert cone concentrator in ore processing. Industrie Minerale - Mineralurgie Nov 1979, pp 223-232.

3. King R P Flowsheet optimization using simulation: A gravity concentrator using Reichert Cones. Proc 21st International Mineral Processing Congress, Rome 2000.

DMCY: Dense-medium cyclone

Simulation of the dense-medium cyclone using a modified version of Lynch's equation for the partition curve. The cut point can be defined either by the Gottfried-Jacobsen procedure or the density of the medium can be specified. In the latter case the normalized cut point shift is calculated for each particle size according to the model developed in the M V Rueda study and in King R P and Juckes A H. "Performance of a dense-medium cyclone when beneficiating fine coal". Coal Preparation 5 (1988) 185-210. Corrected imperfection varies with particle size and the cyclone diameter and is calculated according to the Rueda data and to the King and Juckes model.

Form 49 Form to specify parameters for model DMCY for the dense-medium cyclone.

Parameters:

- 1...Operating density of the medium OR the target cut point.
- 2...Cyclone diameter.
- 3...Selector for the model. 1=Gottfried-Jacobsen cut point ratio. 2=Cutpoint shift.

SPIR: Spiral concentrator.

This model includes the effects of particle size and particle density simultaneously. The model predicts that the recovery of any type of particle will pass through a minimum as the particle size changes.

The cutpoint increases with feed rate. The rate of increase is linear according to Gallagher E, Ellis R, Pitt G, Partridge A C, Randell J K. The integration of a 300t/hr spiral installation at the German Creek preparation plant. Coal Preparation 12 (1993) 163-186. This is consistent with the King Juckes and Stirling data.

The inner splitter must be set equal to outer splitter position if no middling product is taken from the spiral.

Specify parameters for model SPIR

Relative position of inner splitter .5

Relative position of outer splitter .5

Number of spirals in parallel 1

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 50 Form to specify the parameters for spiral model **SPIR**.

Reference:

King R P, Juckes A H and Stirling P A. "A quantitative model for the prediction of fine coal cleaning in a spiral concentrator". Coal Preparation 1992 Vol 11 pp 51-66.

Parameters:

- 1....Relative splitter position for outer splitter.
- 2....Relative splitter position for the inner splitter.
- 3....Number of spirals in parallel.

LISP: SPIRAL CONCENTRATOR

The cut point for each particle size is determined primarily by the position of the cutter at the foot of the spiral. Thus the cutter position is the primary control on the spiral. The King-Juckes-Stirling model is used for water split. The cutpoint increases slightly with feedrate and % solids in the feed.

Specify parameters for model LISP

Relative position of inner splitter .5

Relative position of outer splitter .5

Number of spirals in parallel 1

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current data

☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 51 Form to specify the parameters for model LISP for the spiral concentrator.

References:

Li M, Wood CJ, and Davis JJ "A study of coal washing spirals" Coal Preparation 1993 Vol 12 pp 1117-131.

King R P, Juckes A H and Stirling P A. "A quantitative model for the prediction of fine coal cleaning in a spiral concentrator". Coal Preparation 1992 Vol 11 pp 51-66.

Parameters:

1....Relative splitter position for outer splitter.

2....Relative splitter position for inner splitter.

3....Number of spirals in parallel.

Inner splitter must be set equal to outer splitter position
if no middling product is taken from the spiral.

KELL: SPIRAL CONCENTRATOR (Mineral Deposits Reichert MK10A coal spiral).

Form 52 Form to specify the parameters for model **KELL** for the spiral concentrator.

This model assumes fixed cutter positions and does not make any provision for the control of the cut point. The model allows for the variation of particle recovery with particle size but the model is relatively crude in this respect.

Reference:

Kelly EG, Gomer JS, Pillai KJ, Bull WR, and Spottiswood DJ. Proc. XVI International Mineral Processing Congress Ed. E Forssberg. Elsevier 1988 pp1771-1780

Parameter:

1... Number of spirals in parallel.

KNEL: KNELSON CONCENTRATOR

This model is based on the work of Andre Laplante and his group. The concentrator is assumed to recover a fraction of the free gold. The recovery of free gold is a function of the grain size given by

$$\text{Recovery} = 0.01R_M - 1.718 + 1.885\ln d_p - 0.517(\ln d_p)^2$$

The concentrator also recovers a fraction of the locked gold from the highest-grade locked class in the fine size classes. The recovery is given by

MODSIM - Parameter specification

Specify parameters for model KNEL

Maximum recovery of free gold in percent 88

Recovery of locked gold in percent 25

Solid content of the concentrate in kg solids/liter water 2

Number of units in parallel 1

Data set

☒ New

☐ Current

☐ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 53 Form to specify parameters for model KNEL for the Knelson concentrator.

$$\text{Recovery} = 0.01 R_L \left(\frac{d_{pN}}{d_p} \right)^5$$

The water content of concentrate must be specified as a parameter.

References:

Laplante A R, Woodcock F, and Noaparast M. "Predicting Gravity Separation Gold Recoveries". Minerals & Metallurgical Processing May 1995 pp74-79

Parameters:

Maximum recovery of free gold as a function of grain size (R_M).

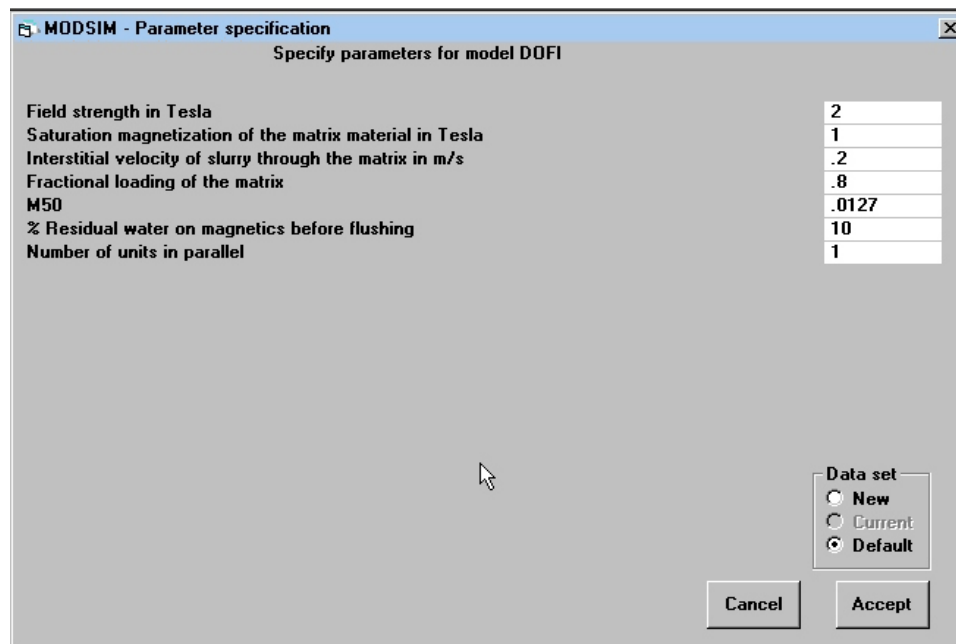
Recovery of locked gold in the finest size(R_L).

Water content of the concentrate in kg solid/ liter of water.

Number of concentrators in parallel.

7.6 Models for Magnetic Separators

DOFI: Wet high-intensity magnetic separator



MODSIM - Parameter specification

Specify parameters for model DOFI

Field strength in Tesla	2
Saturation magnetization of the matrix material in Tesla	1
Interstitial velocity of slurry through the matrix in m/s	.2
Fractional loading of the matrix	.8
M50	.0127
% Residual water on magnetics before flushing	10
Number of units in parallel	1

Data set

☐ New

☐ Current

☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 54 Form to specify the parameters for the wet high intensity magnetic separator model **DOFI**

Dobby and Finch model for the wet high intensity separator. Dobby G and Finch J A An empirical model of capture in a high-gradient magnetic separator and its use in performance prediction. Proc. 12th International Mineral Processing Congress, Sao Paulo, Brazil 1977. Vol 1 pp 128 - 152

Parameters:

- 1.....Magnetic field strength in Tesla
- 2.....Saturation magnetization of the matrix material
- 3.....Interstitial velocity of the slurry through the matrix.
- 4.....Fractional loading on the matrix.
- 5.....M50 value of the group $HGk^{1.2}dp^{2.5}/(U^{1.8}Lm^{0.8})$
- 6.....Residual water on retained magnetics before flushing.
- 7.....Number of units in parallel.

WDMS: Wet drum magnetic separator

A simple recovery model for a wet drum magnetic concentrator

$$\text{ALPHA} = \text{PARAM}(2) * \text{EXP}(-\text{PARAM}(3) * \text{SIZE}(I) / \text{SIZE}(1))$$

$$\text{REC} = (1.0 - \text{ALPHA}) * \text{GRDV}(J, 1) ** \text{PARAM}(1) + \text{ALPHA}$$

Parameters:

Specify parameters for model WDM5

Exponent for recovery curve	2.5
By-pass fraction	.2
Exponent for effect of size on bypass	1.5

Data set

☐ New

☐ Current data

☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 55 Form to specify the parameters for the wet drum magnetic separator model
WDM5

- 1...Exponent on the volumetric fraction non-magnetics to model the recovery.
- 2...By-pass fraction to non magnetics.
- 3...Exponential coefficient to reduce by-pass as size increases.

WDM2: Wet drum magnetic separator

A simple model for a wet drum magnetic concentrator. The partition curve is Rosin-Rammler with the volumetric composition of the particle as the determining variable. The short circuit to non-magnetics increases exponentially as particle size decreases.

$$\text{ALPHA} = \text{PARAM}(3) * \text{EXP}(-\text{PARAM}(4) * \text{SIZE}(I) / 0.001)$$

$$\text{REC} = 1.0 - \text{EXP}(-0.69315 * (\text{GRDV}(J,1) / (1.0 - \text{PARAM}(2))) ** \text{LAMBDA})$$

$$\text{REC} = (1.0 - \text{ALPHA}) * \text{REC} + \text{ALPHA}$$

Parameters:

- 1...Sharpness Index.
- 2...The grade of mineral 2 in the particle that has 50% recovery.
- 3...Small size limit of short circuit fraction to non magnetics.
- 4...Exponential coefficient to reduce by-pass as size increases.
- 5...Water split to tail stream

MODSIM - Parameter specification
Specify parameters for model WDM2

Sharpness Index Allowable range is >0 and <1.0	.75
The grade of mineral 2 in the particle that has 50% recovery	.05
Small size limit of short circuit fraction to non magnetics	.3
Exponential coefficient to reduce by-pass as size increases	20
Water split to tail stream	.8

Data set
☐ New
☐ Current
☒ Default

Cancel Accept

Form 56 form to specify the parameters for the wet drum magnetic separator model **WDM2**

7.7 Models for Material Transport

CONV: Belt conveyer

The conveyer functions essentially as a blender and can take any number of input streams. The capacity of the belt is calculated using the simple geometry of the solid profile to calculate the solid area which is multiplied by the belt velocity. The surface contour of the solid is governed by the angle of repose of the solid and the trough angle of the idlers. More accurate capacities can be obtained from manufacturers' tables or from the SME Handbook section 10. Angles of repose for a range of materials can be found in the SME handbook.

Parameters:

- 1...Width of the belt.
- 2...Freeboard to prevent spillage.
- 3...Idler trough angle.
- 4...Belt speed.
- 5...Angle of repose of the material to be transported.
- 6...Bulk density.

7.8 Models for Coal Washing Units

Most dense medium units that are used to wash coal have similar models. These models are based on a standard generalized partition function which is characterized by the imperfection. The imperfection varies for the different dense-medium vessels and these are hard programmed into MODSIM for each vessel based on a survey of several South African coal washing plants. The cut point is a function of the particle size. The relationship between cut point and particle size is modeled directly for some units using an experimentally determined model for the cut-point shift. The cut-point shift is the difference between the controlled density of the medium and the cut-point at a particular size. For these models the density of the medium must be specified. The effect of particle size in other units are modeled using the Gottfried-Jacobsen method which is based on the specification of a target specific gravity.

NORW

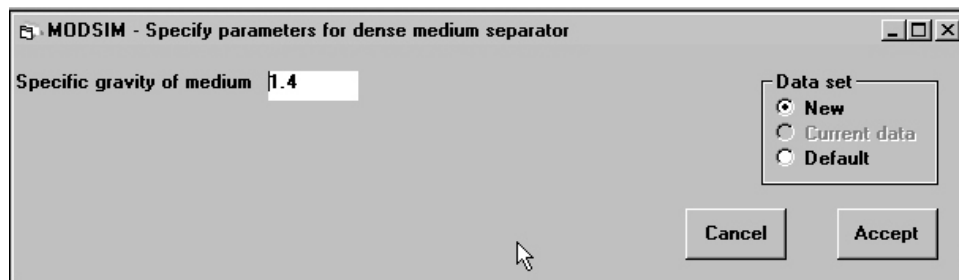
Simulation of the Norwalt coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation for a partition curve. Normalised cut-point shift is assumed constant at 0.005 and the corrected imperfection constant at 0.013.

PARAMETER:

1...Medium density.

WEMC

Simulation of the Wemco drum coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation



Form 57 form to specify parameters for dense medium units **DYNA, TESK, BATJ, SLIP, CHAN, BAUJ, WEMC, NORW** and **WASH**.

for a partition curve.

Normalised cut-point shift is assumed constant at -0.003. (Note negative value) corrected imperfection constant at 0.017.

PARAMETER:

1...Medium density.

DREW

Simulation of the Drewboy coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation for a partition curve. Normalised cut-point shift varies with particle size.

corrected imperfection constant at 0.008.

PARAMETER:

1...Medium density.

CHAN

Simulation of the Chance sand coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation for a partition curve. Normalised cut-point shift is assumed constant at 0.013 and corrected imperfection constant at 0.015.

PARAMETER:

1...Medium density.

SLIP

Simulation of the shallow bath coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation for a partition curve. Normalized cut-point shift varies with particle size. Corrected imperfection is constant at 0.009.

PARAMETER:

1...Medium density.

BAUJ

Simulation of the Baum jig coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation for a partition curve. Normalized cut-point shift is 0. Corrected imperfection varies with feedrate.

PARAMETER:

1...Target separation density.

SHAK

Model for a concentrating table. The Gottfried-Jacobsen procedure is used to estimate the cut-point for each size class. The model is calibrated against data from USBM RI 6239.

PARAMETERS

1....Target cut-point for the separation.

BATJ

Simulation of the Batac jig coal washer using a modified version of Lynch's equation for a partition curve. Short circuit to overflow a function of feederate.

Cutpoint calculated using the Gottfried-Jacobsen procedure. Corrected imperfection constant at 0.06

Data based on the MV RUEDA study and LM TAVARES and J RUBIO. Performance evaluation and simulation of a batac jig cleaning pyrite from coal washery tailings. Presented at 4th Intl. Conf. on Processing and Utilization of High-Sulphur Coals. Idaho Falls 1991

PARAMETERS

1....Target cut-point for the separation.

WASH

Coal washing unit according to B.S.GOTTFRIED INT J MIN PROCESS. 5 (1978)1-20

Data for composite feed to the Drewboy.

PARAMETERS

1....Target cut-point for the separation.

DRUM

Model for a dense-medium coarse coal washing drum. The Gottfried-Jacobsen procedure is used to estimate the cut-point for each size class. Corrected imperfection is a function of particle size.

Data based on USBM RI 7154

PARAMETERS

1...Target cut-point for the separation.

TESK

No model is available for the Teska Drum.

WOCY: Water-only cyclone.

Form 58 Form to specify parameters for model **WOCY** for a water-only cyclone.

Two models are provided for the calculation of the cutpoint.

- 1..The Gottfried-Jacobsen method using the generalized relationship between the cutpoint ratio and the ratio of particle size to the average size in the feed.
- 2..A simple partition function model based on the data presented by Hornsby D T, Watson S J and Clarkson C J. "Fine coal cleaning by spiral and water washing cyclone". Coal Preparation 1993 12 pp 133-161. The effective cut point is determined primarily by the vortex finder clearance. The performance is specified by providing an estimate of the cut point at 1mm.

The efficiency of separation is calculated following Hornsby et. al. The imperfection defined as $EPM/(d_{50} - 1)$ is assumed to be invariant with particle size.

PARAMETERS

1...Selection of the cut point model

1=Gottfried-Jacobsen

2=Hornsby

2...Target cutpoint for the G-J procedure or cutpoint at 1mm for the Hornsby procedure.

8 RUNNING THE SIMULATOR AND GETTING RESULTS

When the flowsheet, system data and model parameters have been specified, the simulation can be run by choosing **RUN SIMULATION** from the **Run** drop down menu.

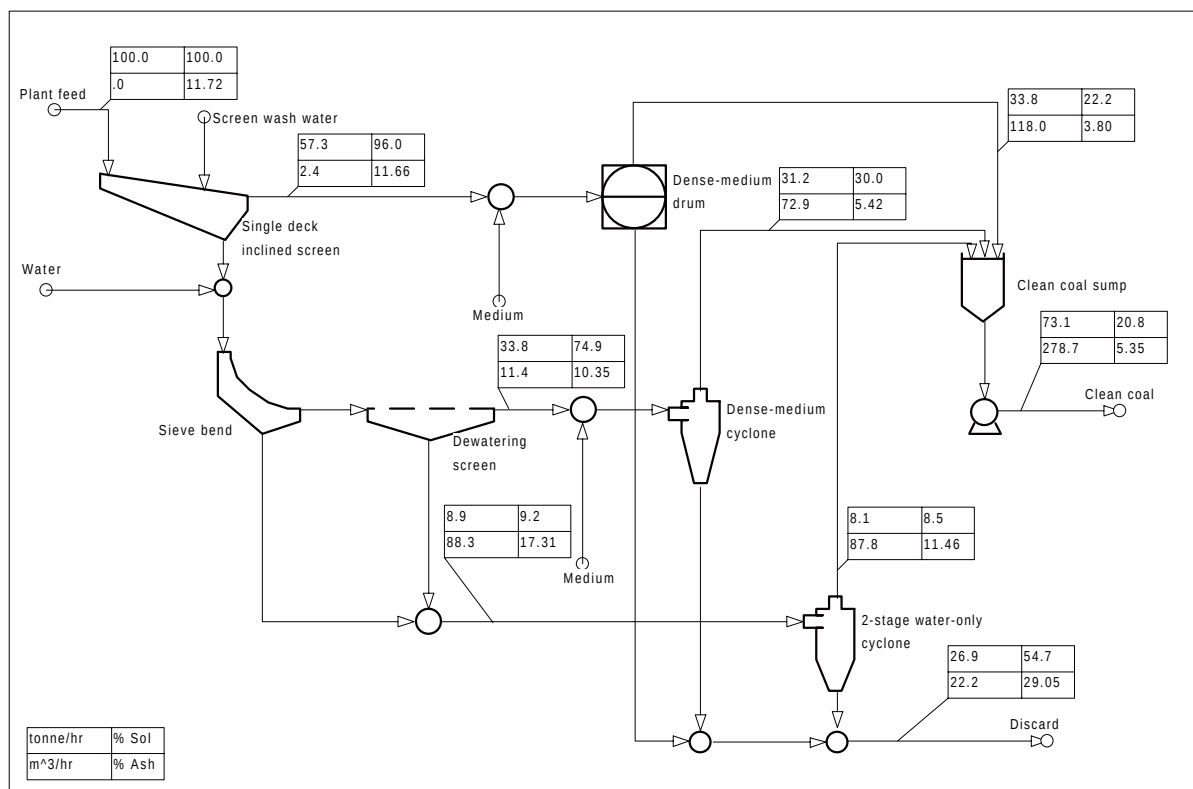


Figure 5 Flowsheet output showing stream flyouts that give summary information on the stream flows.

The simulation output is available in a number of formats that can be accessed easily. The first level of output data can be obtained from the flowsheet itself. This can be accessed by clicking **View flowsheet** from the **View** drop down menu. A typical flowsheet view is shown in Figure 5. Flyouts containing the total solids flowrate, the water flowrate, the percentage solids in the stream and an optional mineral or metal grade, can be attached to any stream using the **Add stream flyout** entry on the **edit** drop down menu on the flowsheet editor. The units used for the data in the stream flyouts are specified in the output format screen which is accessed from the **edit** menu. Stream flyouts can be deleted and moved like any other objects on the flowsheet. A right mouse click on any unit in the flowsheet will bring up the report file for that unit in its own window and any special graphic output that is specific to the unit. A right click on any stream in the flowsheet will bring up a summary of the stream contents including solid and water flowrates, particle-size distribution, d_{80} , d_{50} and d_{20} sizes.

The composition displayed in the lower right hand box of the stream flyouts is the first element listed in the **Metals or elements** list of the output format screen.

8.1 The Output Data File

The next most immediately useful output is a tabular summary of the material balance in

Stream	Solid flow tonne/hr	Water flow s kg/s	% solids	Yield of Solids	Rec. of Cher	Grade of Cher	Rec. of Magn	Grade of Magn	Rec. of Fe	Grade of Fe	
1	100.01	0.0	100.00	100.00	100.00	85.00	100.00	15.00	100.00	10.86	
2	263.56	93.1	44.00	263.53	262.79	84.76	267.86	15.25	267.86	11.04	
3	163.55	18.6	70.91	163.53	162.81	84.62	167.76	15.39	167.76	11.14	
4	100.01	74.5	27.15	100.00	99.98	84.98	100.10	15.02	100.10	10.87	
5	0.00	74.5	0.00								
6	163.55	18.6	70.91	163.53	162.79	84.61	167.86	15.40	167.86	11.15	

Form 59 A typical presentation of the output data for each stream in the flowsheet.

the plant. This is accessed by clicking the **Simulation results** item on the view menu. The data is presented as mass flowrates of appropriate species in each stream together with the stream assays. The stream assay will be appropriate to the type of material that is processed. A typical set of output data is shown in Form 59 and Table 2. The data in Form 59 can be copied and pasted directly to most popular spreadsheets

Table 2 Summary material balance for a typical coal washing plant flowsheet.

Stream number	Solid flow tonne/hr	Water flow m ³ /hr	% solids	Solids yield %	Rec. of Ash	Grade of Ash	Rec. of Comb	Grade of Comb	Rec. of Ash	Grade of Ash	CV MJ/kg	Sulf %
1	100.01	0.00	100.00	100.00	100.00	13.34	100.00	86.66	100.00	13.34	30.36	1.16
2	42.73	-2.39	105.92	42.73	41.98	13.11	42.83	86.86	41.98	13.11	30.45	1.19
3	42.73	99.68	30.01	42.73	41.98	13.11	42.83	86.86	41.98	13.11	30.45	1.19
4	40.00	69.77	36.44	39.99	38.20	12.74	40.27	87.26	38.20	12.74	30.60	1.18
5	33.81	11.35	74.87	33.81	30.03	11.85	34.39	88.15	30.03	11.85	30.94	1.17
6	2.72	29.91	8.34	2.72	3.78	18.52	2.56	81.49	3.78	18.52	28.41	1.26
7	6.19	58.43	9.58	6.19	8.18	17.63	5.88	82.34	8.18	17.63	28.74	1.25
8	0.00	102.06	0.00									
9	33.81	78.91	29.99	33.81	30.03	11.85	34.39	88.15	30.03	11.85	30.94	1.17
10	0.00	67.54	0.00									
11	57.28	2.39	96.00	57.27	58.02	13.52	57.17	86.51	58.02	13.52	30.28	1.14
12	57.28	133.67	30.00	57.27	58.02	13.52	57.17	86.51	58.02	13.52	30.28	1.14
13	0.00	131.29	0.00									
14	8.91	88.34	9.16	8.91	11.95	17.90	8.44	82.10	11.95	17.90	28.65	1.25
15	45.25	125.64	26.48	45.25	18.98	5.60	49.31	94.43	18.98	5.60	33.38	1.13
16	28.51	66.53	30.00	28.51	11.12	5.20	31.18	94.80	11.12	5.20	33.53	1.13
17	7.43	87.34	7.84	7.43	4.90	8.81	7.82	91.20	4.90	8.81	32.14	1.12
18	12.02	8.02	60.00	12.02	39.04	43.32	7.86	56.68	39.04	43.32	18.62	1.18
19	5.30	12.38	29.99	5.30	18.91	47.58	3.21	52.44	18.91	47.58	17.03	1.37
20	17.33	20.39	45.94	17.33	57.95	44.63	11.07	55.38	57.95	44.63	18.13	1.24
21	1.48	0.99	60.00	1.48	7.05	63.55	0.62	36.44	7.05	63.55	11.08	1.93
22	18.81	21.38	46.80	18.80	65.00	46.12	11.69	53.89	65.00	46.12	17.58	1.29
23	81.22	279.50	22.51	81.21	35.00	5.75	88.31	94.23	35.00	5.75	33.31	1.13
24	81.22	279.50	22.51	81.21	35.00	5.75	88.31	94.23	35.00	5.75	33.31	1.13

This file can be printed or saved for archival purposes or imported directly in tabular form into any word processor document.

The format of this display can be changed to suit the problem on hand by executing

Form 60 Form to design the output format of the data output file.

the **Edit output format** on the **edit** menu. This brings up form 60 which allows you to format the output data file to meet the needs of the particular problem.

8.2 Graphs of the Particle Size Distributions

Form 61 Form to setup the graphical output of the particle size distributions in selected streams. This form is entered by selecting the Output PSD graphs item from the main menu.

The next level of detail is the particle size distribution of the solid material in each stream. This is available in both tabular and graphical form. The graphical output is obtained by executing the **Output PSD graphs** from the main menu. The graph is set up using Form 61.

Select plant streams to plot: This field contains a list of the streams in the flowsheet. Double click the streams that are to be included in the plot. The selected streams will be listed in the graph field.

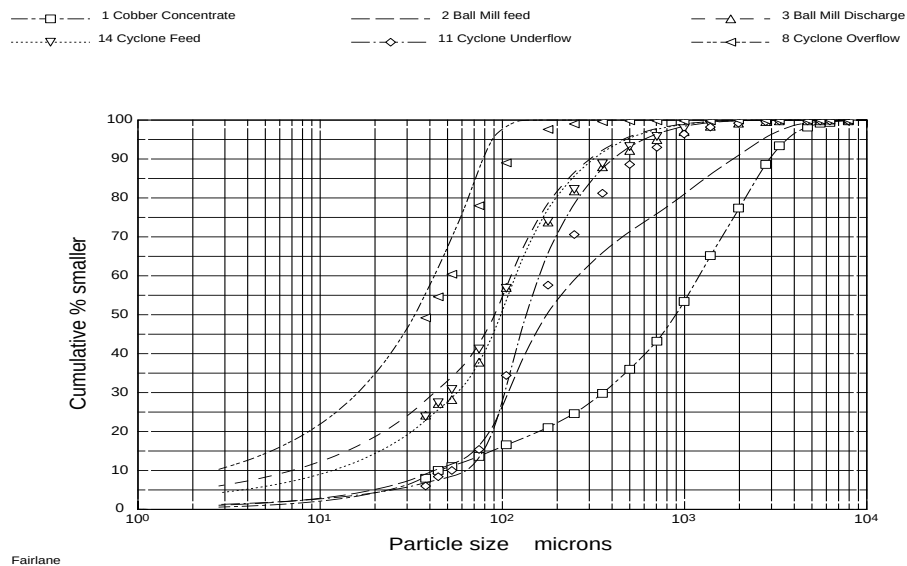
Graph: This field contains the list of selected stream numbers. To remove a stream from the list, double click the stream number in this field.

Coordinates: Two different coordinate systems are provided for plotting the cumulative particle size distributions — log-log and log-linear.

Show experimental data: If experimental data for the size distribution in any stream was specified as system data, this can be shown on the PSD plots by checking this field.

View graph: Click this control to display the graph.

Close: Click this control to return to the main menu.



Form 62 An example of the display of particle size distribution plots. This plot is generated using Form 61.

The graph can be exported as a PostScript file or as an encapsulated PostScript file. To export the graph as an encapsulated PostScript file, the EPSI file must be generated when the graph is showing on the screen by pressing key F3. The EPSI file can be exported once the graph has terminated. Click **Export as EPSI file** from

the **File** drop down menu. Encapsulated PostScript files are particularly useful for importing into word processors and other applications. If you do not have access to a PostScript printer, you can produce high-quality hard copy by importing the EPSI file into your usual word processor and printing the resulting document to your usual printer.

An example of the graphical display is shown in Form 62.

8.3 The Liberation Spectra

The liberation spectrum for the material in each stream is provided in tabular and graphical form whenever this is relevant to the plant operation. The tabular output is in the data output file. The liberation spectra can be plotted by selecting the **Liberation distribution graphs** entry in the **View** menu.

Select plant streams to plot: This field contains a list of the streams in the flowsheet. Double click the streams that are to be included in the plot. The selected streams will be listed in field **Graph**

Graph: This field contains the list of selected stream numbers. To remove a stream from the list, double click the stream number in this field.

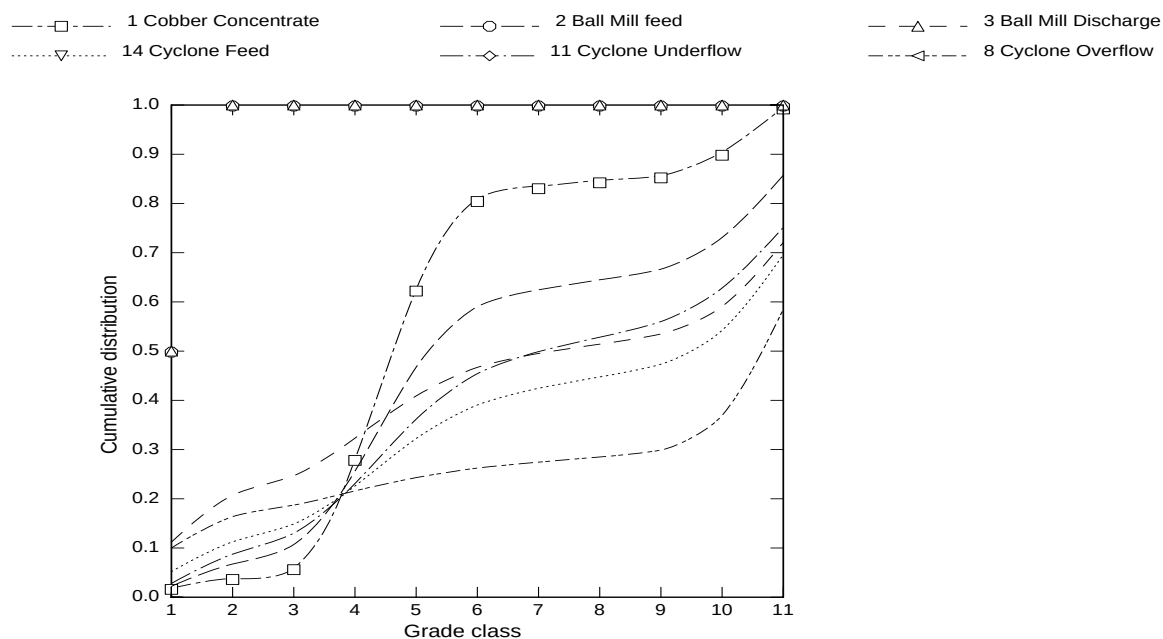


Figure 6 Example of liberation distribution graphs plotted in cumulative form .

Show experimental data: If experimental data for the size distribution in any stream was specified as systems data, this can be shown on the particle size distribution graphs by checking this field.

View graph: Click this control to display the graph.

An example of the liberation spectra graphical output is shown in Figure 7.

8.4 The Report File

The next level of detail of output is provided by copious status reports on each of the units in the plant. An example of an entry in a typical report file is shown below. Each report is appropriate to the type of model that was selected to describe the behavior of the units and the reports will reflect the duty that the unit will actually be called upon to meet at its position in the plant. Models that are specifically developed for plant design and equipment selection will provide a guide to assist the design engineer choose the appropriate equipment. Models that are developed as true simulators will report on the performance of each unit in relation to the required duty. The report file generally will report on overload or underload conditions and any other information that will assist the engineer to determine the actual status of the operating unit and will assist in the diagnosis of operating problems. It is generally easy to identify and locate bottlenecks in the plant and to find cost effective solutions which may immediately be tested by further simulation. An example of a report file for a unit is given below.

The report file can be viewed in its entirety by clicking **report file** on the **view** drop down menu. The quickest way to access the report file for a particular unit is by right clicking the unit icon on the **view flowsheet** screen.

An example of a unit model report file

```
Unit number      2          MODSIM model name GMIL
Mill has 3 well-mixed segments in series without classification.
PARAMETERS:
Residence time in the mill          4.00 minutes.
Calculated tonnage through mill     772.49 tons/hr.
Calculated hold up in mill          51.50 tons.
Mineral liberation parameter PHIA.   50.0
Liberation model used...            Ljubljana
```

Standard Austin selection function for taconite was used
Standard breakage function for taconite was used

Size distribution in FEED

Size mms	% passing
8.08	99.97
5.70	99.72
4.04	98.70
2.85	95.81
2.02	91.23
1.43	86.45
1.01	81.18
.713	76.11
.505	71.49
.357	66.03
.252	59.34
.178	50.58
.126	37.61
.892E-01	21.60
.631E-01	13.35
.446E-01	10.39
.315E-01	7.61
.223E-01	5.61
.158E-01	4.17
.112E-01	3.12
.788E-02	2.35
.557E-02	1.79
.394E-02	1.38
.279E-02	1.07
.000	.00

Size distribution in HOLDUP

Size mms	% passing
8.08	100.00
5.70	100.00
4.04	99.97
2.85	99.84
2.02	99.50
1.43	98.88
1.01	97.73
.713	95.92
.505	93.29
.357	89.26
.252	83.34
.178	74.80
.126	61.88
.892E-01	45.12
.631E-01	34.04
.446E-01	27.80
.315E-01	22.19
.223E-01	17.77
.158E-01	14.29
.112E-01	11.57
.788E-02	9.42
.557E-02	7.72
.394E-02	6.37
.279E-02	5.28
.000	.00

Size distribution in PRODUCT

Size mms	% passing
8.08	100.00
5.70	100.00
4.04	100.00
2.85	99.98
2.02	99.89
1.43	99.66
1.01	99.07
.713	97.89
.505	95.84
.357	92.35
.252	86.88
.178	78.65
.126	65.97
.892E-01	49.26
.631E-01	37.74
.446E-01	30.93
.315E-01	24.82
.223E-01	19.97
.158E-01	16.12
.112E-01	13.09
.788E-02	10.69
.557E-02	8.78
.394E-02	7.26
.279E-02	6.03
.000	.00

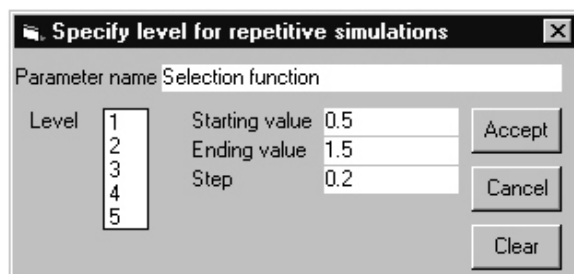
80% passing size in feed 928.5 microns
80% passing size in product 187.9 microns
The power required can be calculated from the Bond work
index of the material.
Power required = 310.1x W.I.

The final level of detail in the output is an extensive tabular listing giving the flowrate of every particulate species in every stream in the plant. It is only very seldom that this output needs to be examined and it is hardly ever used.

8.5 Repetitive Simulations (Professional version only)

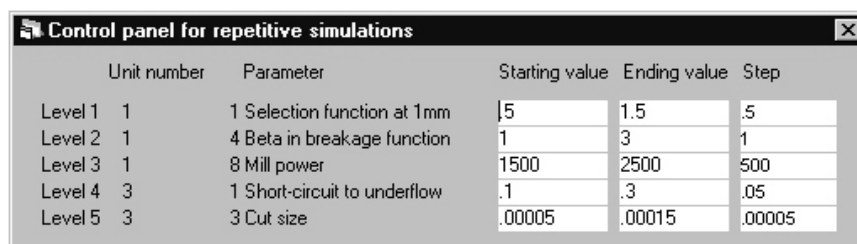
It is often useful to be able to run several simulations automatically with varying parameters for the different unit. This facilitates finding unit parameter settings that should be used to match observed experimental data for one or more process streams in the plant. Repetitive simulation is also useful to find combinations of unit parameters that optimize plant performance. This operation is easy to set up and implement in MODSIM.

It is possible to vary up to 5 unit parameters in 5 nested loops in which the



Form 63 Pop-up menu to set repeat level and repeat values for a unit parameter.

parameters are varied automatically according to the pattern set by the user. With very few exceptions, any unit parameter that can be set can be chosen as a variable in one or more of the nested loops. The loop that is controlled by a particular parameter is called the level for that parameter. To assign a parameter to a particular level, the parameter is selected from the unit parameter editing form for the appropriate unit. Cntrl-click the parameter input field for the parameter to generate the pop-up menu shown as Form 63. A descriptive name can be assigned to the parameter so that this can be identified properly in the output. Specify the starting value for the parameter, the ending value and the step length. The level to which this parameter is assigned must also be specified. This procedure can be repeated for up to 5 parameters. These can all be associated with the same unit or they can be selected from any combination of units in the flowsheet.



	Unit number	Parameter	Starting value	Ending value	Step
Level 1	1	1 Selection function at 1mm	.5	1.5	.5
Level 2	1	4 Beta in breakage function	1	3	1
Level 3	1	8 Mill power	1500	2500	500
Level 4	3	1 Short-circuit to underflow	.1	.3	.05
Level 5	3	3 Cut size	.00005	.00015	.00005

Form 64 Levels editor for repetitive simulations

The repetitive simulation pattern can be edited using the **Edit repetitive simulation data** item on the **Edit** menu. The level editor is shown in Form 64

Repetitive simulations produce a special data output form. It is necessary to select the streams that must be displayed on the output format editor. The accumulated output from the repetitive simulations can be displayed by selecting the **accumulated output** entry on the **View** menu.

9 COAL WASHING PLANTS

MODSIM can also handle coal washing plants and both data input and output

MODSIM - Washability data for a single size fraction

Job: sc13V3 Coal sample: 1 Plant feed

Size range: 75 to 37.5 ☒ mm ☐ inch ☐ microns ☐ mesh

Number of washability classes: 10 ☐ Fixed C ☐ Volatiles ☒ Calorific value ☐ Moisture ☒ Total Sulfur ☒ Pyritic Sulfur

	Density	Av. density	Weight %	Ash %	Fixed C %	Volatiles %	Moisture %	Cal. value	Tot S %	Pyr Sulfur %
Fleet	1.30	1.299	37.7	2.96				34.453	.990	0.02
1.30	- 1.35	1.325	31.1	5.93				33.232	1.130	0.97
1.35	- 1.40	1.375	1.9	11.04				31.052	1.830	1.60
1.40	- 1.45	1.425	1.4	16.07				29.000	1.680	1.54
1.45	- 1.50	1.475	2.4	22.70				26.572	1.260	1.10
1.50	- 1.60	1.550	4	28.99				24.150	.910	0.00
1.60	- 1.70	1.650	3.7	36.43				21.218	.830	0.76
1.70	- 1.80	1.750	2.9	45.71				17.429	.580	0.53
1.80	- 2.17	1.985	9	58.99				12.319	.880	0.75
2.17	- Sink	2.500	5.9	81.52				4.363	2.380	2.22

Data specified as: ☒ Fractional ☐ Cumulative

Units for calorific value: ☒ MJ/kg ☐ Btu/lb

formats are available to suit the normal common usage of coal processing technologists. The data input format is shown in Form 65.

Coal sample: Identifying name for this stream.

Size range: Particle size range for this washability set. Each size range for which washability data is available requires a separate form.

Number of washability fractions: Specify the number of density fractions that are available for this size fraction.

☐ **Ash:** Check if ash content is known for each washability fraction in this data set.

☐ **Fixed C:** Check if fixed carbon is known for each fraction in this data set.

☐ **Volatiles:** Check if % volatiles are known for each fraction in this data set.

☐ **Moisture:** Check if moisture is known for each fraction in this data set.

☐ **Cal. Value:** Check if the calorific value is known for each fraction in this data set.

Units are MJ/kg.

[] Sulfur: Check if the sulfur content is known for each fraction in this data set.

Density: Specify the density at the boundaries of each washability fraction.

Weight %: This column requires the weight percent in each washability fraction. The data can be specified as fractional or cumulative.

() Fract () Cum Specify data in fractional or cumulative form.

10 WRITING SUBROUTINES FOR UNIT MODELS

Probably the most important feature of MODSIM is the facility to incorporate any model for a particular unit operation. The models must satisfy a minimum set of requirements and must be coded in Fortran according to the specifications listed below.

10.1 Model Subroutine Structure

Unit model subroutines are written in FORTRAN. Normally, all data required in the model are transmitted via the argument list but the user can transmit data freely through named COMMON.

Unit models are identified to the simulator by a 4-character (alphanumeric) subroutine name which may be chosen by the user. The argument list must necessarily be uniform for all subroutines and is defined by the following format.

```
SUBROUTINE  name(TMSF, TMS1, TCMS2, TMS3, FEED, OUT1, OUT2, OUT3,
DER1, DER2, DER3, NDC, NGC, NSC, WTR, WTR1, WTR2, WTR3, SIZE,
PARAM, PPROP, INDPP, FL, NPP, GRDM, GRDC, NMIN, NGCM)

REAL FEED(NDC, NGC, NSC)
REAL OUT1(NDC, NGC, NSC), OUT2(NDC, NGC, NSC), OUT3(NDC, NGC, NSC)
REAL DER1(NDC, NGC, NSC), DER2(NDC, NGC, NSC), DER3(NDC, NGC, NSC)
REAL GRDM(NGCM, NMIN), GRDV(NGCM, NMIN)
REAL SIZE(1), PARAM(1), PPROP(1)
INTEGER INDPP(NPP, 2), FL
COMMON NPLNT, NUNIT, ITER, IW, IFLAG
```

Object time dimensioning for subscripted variables is used so that models need not be changed to suit different ore and mineral suites. The simulator ensures that dimensions are consistent throughout for each problem. This device also means that the subroutines can be compiled once for all thus minimizing waiting time.

The particulate state is described by 3-way classification. The particle population is distributed according to particle size (the D-classes), to mineralogical composition (the G-classes) and a third variable which is left free for specification by the user (the S-classes). The size distribution is normally based on a geometric progression for the interval boundaries while the G-classes normally included liberated mineral and liberated gangue as well as one or more types of locked particle. The S-classes are normally used for the distribution of flotation rate constants if flotation is used as a unit operation cut can be used for any other particle property that can take distributed values. Every ore dressing plant

must have more than one class in at least one of the three categories otherwise it will not achieve any useful purpose. Consult section 4.1 *Setting up Grade Classes* and section 4.3 *Setting up S-classes* to see how these class structures are set up in MODSIM. MODSIM will set up the size classes using a geometric progression of 25 size intervals starting at the **largest particle size** entered on Form 3.

The variables in the argument list are either transmitted by the simulator or are returned by the subroutine to the simulator as defined in the following lists.

Arguments transmitted by simulator to subroutine and which are available for use in the model.

TMSF	total mass flow of solids in the feed, <i>kg/s</i> .
FEED(I,J,K)	mass flowrate of solids in D-class I, G-class J and S-class K, <i>kg/s</i> .
NDC	number of D classes.
NGC	number of G classes.
NSC	number of S classes.
WTR	water flowrate to unit, <i>kg/s</i> .
SIZE	vector of particle sizes, units are in meters and sizes are in descending order.
PARAM	vector of parameter values for this unit models.
PPROP	vector of all physical properties used in the simulator.
INDPP	index of physical properties. Physical property I has its first element in vector PPROP in position INDPP(I,1) and has INDPP(I,2) elements.
FL	condition indicator that is set to zero by the simulator when the subroutine is entered (see below).
NPP	number of physical properties in use by the simulator.
GRDM	two-dimensional array containing the mass distribution of minerals in each G class.
GRDV	two-dimensional array containing the volume distribution of minerals in each G class.
NMIN	number of minerals.
NGCM	maximum number of G classes in all plants in the flowsheet.

Arguments transmitted by subroutine to simulator.

TMS1	total mass flowrate of solids in tailings stream <i>kg/s</i> .
TMS2	total mass flowrate of solids in concentrate stream if any, <i>kg/s</i> .
TMS3	total mass flowrate of solids in middlings stream if any, <i>kg/s</i> .
OUT1(I,J,K)	flowrate of solid in D-class I, G-class J, and S-class K in the tailings, <i>kg/s</i> .
OUT2(I,J,K)	flowrate of solid in D-class I, G-class J and S-class K in the concentrate, <i>kg/s</i> .
OUT3(I,J,K)	flowrate of solid in D-class I, G-class J and S-class K in the middling <i>kg/s</i> .
DER1(I,J,K)	partial derivative of OUT1(I,J,K) with respect to FEED(I,J,K).
DER2(I,J,K)	partial derivative of OUT2(I,J,K) with respect of FEED(I,J,K).
DER3(I,J,K)	partial derivative of OUT3(I,J,K) with respect to FEED(I,J,K).
WTR1	water flowrate in tailing, <i>kg/s</i> .
WTR2	water flowrate in concentrate if any, <i>kg/s</i> .

WTR3 water flowrate in middling if any, kg/s.
 FL output code = 1 if partial derivatives are calculated; = 2 not
 defined; = 3 fatal error in subroutine, simulation must terminate;
 = 4 the unit is overloaded.

NOTES:

- i. The simulator always supplies quantities in SI units and unit model subroutines should be written appropriately.
- ii. Not all units have concentrate or middling streams but every unit must have a tailing stream.
- iii. The calculation of the partial derivatives is not essential but convergence is facilitated if they are.

The five entries in COMMON are supplied by the simulator and are defined by

NPLNT the number of the plant currently being simulated.
 NUNIT the number of the unit currently being calculated.
 ITER the number of the current iteration.
 IW the logical unit number of the output device associated with the
 output file.
 IFLAG a flag that has value 0 before convergence and is set equal to 1 for
 the last pass through the model subroutine at convergence. This is
 useful for output of information regarding the unit when the material
 balance has been attained.

These items of data are available for use in the subroutine if required.

The structure of the subroutine must provide the calculated output flowrates using the input flowrates in each particle class as specified. Provided that the necessary outputs are completely specified there is no restriction on the structure of the unit models. They may be as simple or as complex as is required by the nature of the problem on hand.

The unit model subroutines should be maintained by the user in a separate file. The compiled object code must be available for linking to program PHO2.

10.2 Accessing System Data in Model Subroutines

Data that is relevant to the system as a whole such as the rate and composition of the feed to a unit or the physical properties of the ore are available for use within the model subroutine from three sources: the arguments of the subroutine call, the common data areas in the subroutine and in the list of physical properties. The subroutine arguments are explained in the previous section and they may be used directly within the subroutine. These variables are common to all subroutines and every subroutine will use some or all of them. The variables in the common blocks are used occasionally from within the subroutine. For example, some results from within the subroutine can be sent to the output file on the last pass through the subroutine. This is detected when IFLAG = 1. The logical unit number for the output file is IW.

The physical properties of the ore are all available for use within the model subroutines. MODSIM establishes an indexed list of physical properties in argument PPROP as defined

in Section 10.1. The index is set up in variable INPPP. The order in which specific physical properties are inserted into the list is defined in the following table.

Table 4 List of physical properties that are available in model subroutines.

Physical property	Property number
Specific gravity of G-class	1
Mineralogical texture parameter Φ_A	2
Magnetic susceptibility of G-class	3
Any other property that is associated with a G-class. See Form 4.	4
Flotation rate constants associated with S-classes.	5
Magnetic susceptibility of S-classes.	6
Any other property that is associated with S-classes. See Form 6.	7
Calorific value that is associated with a washability (G-classes) class.	8
Total sulfur that is associated with a washability class.	9
Pyritic sulfur that is associated with a washability class.	10

For example the density of material in G-class 3 would be calculated in a unit model subroutine as

$$\text{DENSITY} = \text{PPROP}(3) * 1000.0$$

The default specific flotation rate constant for S-class 2 would be calculated as

$$\text{RateConstant} = \text{PPROP}(\text{INDPP}(5,1)+1)$$

10.3 Accessing Unit Model Parameters

The unit models require operating parameters that will usually be varied from one simulation to the next. Unit parameters are specified from the UNIT PARAMETER screen (Form 12) that is accessible from the main menu. Obviously parameter specification is specific to the individual models and each model subroutine must have its associated parameter input list. This list is inserted in file MODQUES.DAT and has the following format (each record on a separate line).

```

Model subroutine name.
Number of parameters for this subroutine.
Text to identify first parameter, Default value for this
parameter, Conversion code.
```


Text to identify second parameter, Default value for this parameter, Conversion code.
Repeated for each parameter.

The conversion code can take any one of three values: NONE, SIZE or DENS. These values specify that a choice of units will be provided if the code is SIZE or DENS in which case units for size or density will be provided respectively. An example of the use of this feature is given in section 10.8 and the resulting data input form is shown as Form 17 on page 31 .

10.4 Handling Water Feeds in Unit Subroutines

Whenever a model must accommodate a separate water feed directly to the unit, the model subroutine must be able to detect this and take appropriate action that reflects the fate of this water in the unit. To do this use data in the COMMON block named **WATERFEED**. MODSIM sends data in this common block to the unit subroutine. If water is added directly to the unit, the logical variable **UNITFEED** will be set true. The variable **SOLIDCONT** will contain the required solid content in the product stream (mass %) or the variable **WATERADD** will contain the desired water addition rate in kg/s.

10.5 Handling Pseudo Streams in Unit Subroutines

If a unit has a pseudo stream drawn on the flowsheet, the information that this stream must transmit is placed in the first available OUTn(NDC,NGC,NSC) variable. Add 10 to the value of variable FL.

10.6 Setting up the Report File

Each model subroutine must generate the data and information that is to appear in the Report File. The most convenient way to create this is to clone the unit model subroutine into the file UNITREPS.FOR and add any formatted output that should go to the Report File.

10.7 An Example of a Unit Model Subroutine

Consider a separation operation to be defined for use in a plant where only the mineralogical composition of the individual particles is significant. Such a model would be appropriate for a simple magnetic or gravity separation treating a well-sized feed. The recoveries of each mineral type and of the water are presumed to be provided as parameters. The FORTRAN subroutine is:

```
SUBROUTINE SEPR(TMSF,TMS1,TMS2,TMS3,FEED,OUT1,OUT2,
OUT3,DER1,DER2,DER3,NDC,NGC,NSC,WTR,WTR1,WTR2,WTR3,SIZE,
PARAM,PPROP,INDPP,FL,NPP,GRDM,GRDV,NMIN,NGCM)
REAL FEED(NDC,NGC,NSC)
```

```

REAL OUT1(NDC, NGC, NSC), OUT2(NDC, NGC, NSC), OUT3(NDC, NGC, NSC)
REAL DER1(NDC, NGC, NSC), DER2(NDC, NGC, NSC), DER3(NDC, NGC, NSC)
REAL GRDM(NGCM, NMIN), GRDV(NGCM, NMIN)
REAL SIZE(NDC), PARAM(*), PPROP(*)
INTEGER INDPP(NPP, 2), FL
COMMON NPLNT, NUNIT, ITER, IW, IFLAG
TMS2 = 0.0
DO K = 1, NSC
  DO J = 1, NGC
    DO I = 1, NDC
      OUT2(I, J, K)=PARAM(J)*FEED(I, J, K)
      OUT1(I, J, K)=FEED(I, J, K) - OUT2(I, J, K)
      DER2(I, J, K)=PARAM(J)
      DER1(I, J, K)=1.0 - PARAM(J)
      TMS2 = TMS2 + OUT2(I, J, K)
    END DO
  END DO
END DO
TMS1 = TMSF - TMS2
FL = 1
WTR2 = PARAM(NGC+1)*WTR
WTR1 = WTR - WTR2
RETURN
END

```

The most convenient way to write a new model subroutine is to copy the blank template from file **TEMPLATE.FOR** and place the required code in the indicated positions.

10.8 An Example of a Parameter Input entry in File MODQUES.DAT

```

CRSH
5
Closed-side set, 0.0254, SIZE
Proportion of fines produced during a breakage event K, 0.2, NONE
Impact work index of the material kwhr/tonne, 12, NONE
Proportionality constant between CSS or OSS and d1 - Alpha1, 0.653, NONE
Proportionality constant between CSS or OSS and d2 - Alpha2, 1.6, NONE

```

10.9 Inserting new Models for Units

The system has been designed to facilitate the insertion of new models for the unit operations. These models must be programmed as FORTRAN subroutines according to the rules defined in Section 10.

The model subroutine and its associated parameter input subroutine must be compiled in files UNITS.FOR.

In addition, a small entry is required in file PLANT.DAT. Each unit has an entry in this file which is structured as follows:

abcde

f

NAME

Where a = the number of the key in the keyboard list (file PLOT.DAT) to select this unit.

b,c,d and e define the region of influence of the unit on the flowsheet. This region is defined as a rectangle with sides to the left, right, top and bottom of the unit location point.

f = the number of models available for this unit.

NAME = the four-character name of the model subroutine (one name per line)

Only f and NAME are relevant to new models that are to be attached to existing icons.

To insert a new model, f is increased by 1 for the appropriate unit and the subroutine name is added to the list. Note that fixed format is required and the value of f must be right justified in column 2.

The program PARSET must be run after modifying file PLANT.DAT. This produces programs PARSEL and SEQSEL. However it is best simply to run the MAKEFILE using NMAKE which will recompile the entire system.

11 TROUBLESHOOTING

Error messages are displayed whenever MODSIM encounters a problem with a particular simulation. By far the most common source of difficulty is an incorrect or incompatible data file that is sent to the simulator. The data file can be examined by clicking **View data echo file** from the **Run** drop down menu of the main window. This will display your data set as the simulator has interpreted it. Make sure that the data set is exactly compatible with the flowsheet that you have drawn. Check the stream connection listing to ensure that all the streams do connect to units as you intended. The parameters for each unit model should also be carefully checked. It is possible to specify unit parameters that are incompatible with your flowsheet arrangement so that no valid simulation is possible. The more complex the flowsheet, the greater the likelihood of incompatible parameter specification. It is always best and almost always quickest to build up the flowsheet unit by unit and running a simulation after each unit is added. In this way any computational problems can be ascribed to the last unit added and appropriate remedies taken.

The ultimate diagnostic tool is the DLL diagnostic file that is produced during each simulation run. This file tracks the simulation calculation through each stage and should a failure occur, the cause can usually be pinpointed from the diagnostic file output. The DLL diagnostic file can be view from the **Run** menu on the main window.

The ordering algorithm produces a file that shows the order in which the units will be calculated. This can sometimes be useful when diagnosing errors in the flowsheet. This can be viewed by clicking **View calculation order** from the **Run** drop down menu on the main window.

When the flowsheet contains one or more recycle streams, the simulation calculation is iterative in nature. This can be time consuming and the starting point for the iteration can have a significant effect on the computation time.. MODSIM defaults to start each calculation from the last end point for the job in question. The calculation is made sequential by allocating flowrates for each class of particle in a set of streams called the tear streams. These tears streams are effectively torn open so that there is a sequential computational path from each tear back to itself. Convergence is achieved when every tear calculates back to itself with values for the particle class flows that re within the required tolerance. Hence starting the next calculation from the values of the tear streams that are calculated at the convergence point of the previous calculation will usually lead to faster convergence. It is possible to disable this feature and force the calculation to start from a default condition for each tear stream from Form 7. This is specially important if the calculation terminates abnormally leaving an incomplete specification of the tear streams on file. The current values of the tear stream particle class flows can be viewed by clicking **View tear streams** from the **Run** drop down menu on the main window.

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